

GBA improves coordination on big projects; civic issues persist

Top-level meetings are frequent now, but problems related to blackspots, waste collection, and citizen services continue

Chetan B.C.
BENGALURU

If a positive outcome of the formation of the Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) has to be picked, top-level coordination between various parastatals working in Bengaluru stands first, although there is significant scope for improvement in inter-departmental coordination down the chain.

According to GBA sources, top-level meetings have been frequent, which has particularly helped expedite long-delayed civic works and infrastructure projects.

However, problems faced by people on a daily basis, such as garbage blackspots, waste collection, potholes, and citizen services persist.

For instance, in the last year, work on three major underpasses – Wind Tunnel Junction, Okalipuram, and Katerava Studio underpasses – has finally started. Of the three, the Wind Tunnel and Okalipuram underpasses were significantly delayed owing to coordination issues.

An officer overseeing its implementation told *The Hindu* that after the corporations were formed, top officials of the central city corporations and the BTP



Sore spot: Blackspot clearances, whose responsibility rests with the corporations, depend on Bengaluru Solid Waste Management Ltd. improving the waste collection system so that the cleared blackspot does not reappear. FILE PHOTO

worked on a mutually acceptable working time-frame and began the work. Such meetings were previously impossible because there was no one mediating the talks. However, coordination between lower-rank officials for smaller works is still an issue.

In the city, ₹3,000 crore worth of white-topping works have been approved and are at the implementation stage, an outcome of the faster movement of files. However, implementation gaps have left citizens toiling in traffic.

A senior traffic police officer pointed out how un-

coordinated civic works, along with poor planning, at the lower Agram Road white-topping site choked a key link to central Bengaluru. However, the issue was addressed after a week through on-site changes following meetings. “The problem is when a work is commissioned, there is communication between all departments, but during execution, there is a gap in terms of forming a loop with all the parastatals,” he said.

What has remained unchanged despite multiple meetings is solid waste management. Blackspot clearances, whose responsibility rests with the corporations, depend on Bengaluru Solid Waste

Management Ltd. (BSWML) improving the waste collection system so that the cleared blackspot does not reappear. “Despite sustained efforts to eliminate blackspots, they keep reappearing. One of the reasons for which is lack of coordination. Although such discussion unfolds at the top level, it doesn’t trickle down to ground-level workers, which results in failure to coordinate,” said a corporation Commissioner.

Citizens also observed ground-level execution issues. Sujith Cariappa of the Social Amenities Association, HAL II Stage, pointed out that GBA Chief Commissioner M. Maheshwar Rao held grievance meet-

ings at corporation offices where he noted that certain issues could be solved immediately, but nothing happened on the ground.

However, corporation officials attribute this issue to a shortage of staff. “Over the last year, multiple drives began, and there was a shortage of hands to implement everything. Once the recruitment happens, the system will see substantial improvement,” an engineer said.

Karthik Reddy, Joint Commissioner of Police (Traffic), pointed out that the GBA system has made it easier to communicate between officials and address minor issues. “For example, earlier, if a work was being delayed, a DCP-rank officer had to speak to the BBMP Commissioner, who was of a higher rank, because the Commissioner held all the powers. Now, the Commissioners are also batchmates of DCPs in the city, which has made communication easy,” he said. “There are definitely loopholes, but they will be solved because there is more ground-level work unfolding and that needs constant communication, which will fix the current gaps,” he said.

(This is the fourth in a series of reports evaluating the restructuring of Bengaluru governance with the GBA and five corporations, a year after the reform.)

Public engagement up, revenue generation needs push: GBA chief

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Looking back at one year of the Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA) and the five city corporations, Chief Commissioner M. Maheshwar Rao said decision-making has gained pace and interaction with the public has improved, but there is scope for improving revenue generation.

Mr. Rao said that with the increase in the number of decision-makers at the corporation level, more local, micro-level and long-pending issues are being resolved faster. “Especially works for which budgets can be approved and allocated at the corporation level are being executed quickly. In addition, interaction with citizens has increased, improving the execution of local works,” Mr. Rao said.

However, he admitted that some infrastructure works and revenue generation have been slow, citing two specific reasons: the West Asia crisis, which led to a shortage of bitumen, and various surveys, including the SIR, socio-economic survey and census. “Although the government provided funds and sanctioned works, some could not be implemented due to these reasons,” he said.

He added that revenue collection also could not be improved to the extent that the corporations had initially anticipated and



M. Maheshwar Rao

Maheshwar Rao admits that some infrastructure works, revenue generation have been slow

provided for in the budget. “We were anticipating tax revision, premium floor area ratio (FAR) charges, and other avenues, but couldn’t achieve it. In the coming days, we can do this, and more work can be taken up with those funds,” he said.

He said that coordination and efficiency have improved. Further, the GBA has finalised a place for setting up new corporation offices, while for two corporations, the search for a place is ongoing.

Mr. Rao said that T.M. Vijay Bhaskar, former Chief Secretary, has submitted a report on cadre and recruitment rules for GBA, and it has been sent to the government for approval. One more report is yet to be submitted, after which action will be taken, he said.

Man dies after BMTC bus rams two-wheeler in Nelamangala

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A 25-year-old man was killed and his wife sustained injuries after a BMTC bus rammed their two-wheeler near Urs Colony, within the Nelamangala Traffic Police limits, on Wednesday evening.

The deceased was identified as Manu, a resident of Nelamangala town and a native of Sirsi in Tumakuru district.

He was working as a restaurant manager and had married eight months ago.

According to the police, the accident occurred around 4.30 p.m. when Manu was riding the two-wheeler with his wife on the pillion on Urs Colony Road.

The BMTC bus allegedly hit the two-wheeler from behind, throwing the couple onto the road.

According to the police, Manu fell to the left side of the road and came under the wheels of the bus. He sustained severe injuries and died on the spot. His wife escaped with minor injuries.

The police shifted the body for post-mortem examination.

CCTV footage
Investigators are examining CCTV footage from the area to ascertain the exact circumstances leading to the accident.

A case has been registered and further investigation is under way.

From Page One

NITI Aayog for ‘second Bengaluru’ to ease pressure on city

He said several ambitious projects were at the implementation stage to improve Bengaluru’s infrastructure.

Mr. Shivakumar appealed to the NITI Aayog to have special consideration for Karnataka. “The nation has huge expectations from Karnataka. It is in a leading position in the country in GDP, per capita income, human development index, technology and innovation, foreign direct investment, exports, start-ups, and IT services. Karnataka has the best quality human resources in the country.”

Pointing out that after a long time, Karnataka had got an opportunity to hold a separate meeting with NITI Aayog, the Chief Minister sought its full support to the State.

The Chief Minister requested NITI Aayog to ensure that Karnataka gets its due share of Central funds, including the pending grants that were announced earlier in the Central Budget. In a federal system, States and the Central government must work with mutual cooperation, he noted.

“Recently, while speaking with Union Home Minister Amit Shah, I said that Southern States have properly implemented population control measures, but they should not be punished by reducing fund allocation based on population,” he recalled.

Shivakumar hails women as original creators in society

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Hailing women as the original creators, for whom building and growing anything new is “only natural”, Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Wednesday drew an analogy from the Ramayana to drive home his point.

Speaking at a session on ‘Empowering Women to Build a More Secure Tomorrow’ organised in partnership with Ubuntu Consortium and Federation of Karnataka Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FKCCI), he said, “Sita’s role in the epic is more powerful than that of Ram. The sacrifices of Sita were great, the struggles she faced were incomparable.”

Women, he said, should not be confined to domestic responsibilities when they possess the ability and talent to lead institutions, governments and businesses, and more im-



Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar with women entrepreneurs, industrialists, representatives of financial institutions and industry associations in Bengaluru on Wednesday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

Sita’s role in the epic is more powerful than that of Ram. Her sacrifices were great, the struggles she faced were incomparable

D.K. SHIVAKUMAR
Chief Minister

portantly create jobs. Addressing women entrepreneurs, industrialists,

representatives of financial institutions and industry associations from across India and abroad, the Chief Minister said women could be creators of employment and drivers of social change.

He said the Karnataka government’s schemes such as Shakti, under which women can travel free on State-run buses, and the Gruha Lakshmi, through which women heads of households re-

ceive ₹2,000 a month, help circulate money within the economy by increasing women’s purchasing power. Mr. Shivakumar also referred to concessional credit for women entrepreneurs, saying that the government was providing loans at an interest rate of 4%.

In elected bodies
Mr. Shivakumar said greater participation of women in elected bodies was also essential to strengthening democracy.

With political parties having broadly accepted reservation for women, he added, the focus should now be on ensuring that educated and capable women were prepared to take up leadership positions in panchayats, legislatures, and Parliament.

Turning to Bengaluru, he said women professionals were already playing a significant role in the city’s economy. He noted that

Pensionbazaar, Ubuntu Consortium sign MoU

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Pensionbazaar, a platform focused on retirement and pension planning, and Ubuntu Consortium have signed an MoU to expand access to the National Pension System (NPS) among women workers.

Karnataka will be a significant beneficiary as the State has a large population of working/entrepreneur women.

The MoU was signed in Bengaluru in the presence of Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, alongside Ratna Prabha, formerly Chief Secretary and currently foun-

der-president, Ubuntu Consortium, and Sarbvir Singh, Joint Group CEO, PB Fintech.

Financial resilience
The partnership aims to empower women entrepreneurs to introduce NPS and encourage disciplined, long-term savings among women employed in their enterprises.

The initiative seeks to build greater financial resilience among women employed in small and medium enterprises, and strengthen their participation in India’s formal retirement ecosystem, according to Pensionbazaar.

more than 40% of doctors produced in Bengaluru were women, while the ci-

ty had emerged as one of the world’s major technology centres.

Scientists defy limit on turning heat into electricity

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Scientists from the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research (JNCASR) in a collaborative research have reversed a limit which was accepted for over a century on turning heat into electricity.

Scientists from the JNCASR, along with the University of Sydney, Australia, and the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), stumbled upon a crystalline semiconductor that converts a temperature difference into an electrical voltage nearly a thousand times larger than what textbook physics allows.

“The thermoelectric voltage generated is so large that it rivals values



Current affair: Scientists have stumbled upon a crystalline semiconductor that converts a temperature difference into electrical voltage nearly thousand times larger than textbook physics allows.

normally seen only in liquid electrolytes and ionic gels, not in solid, particularly single-crystalline materials,” the Department of Science and Technology said.

It added that the discovery overturns a decades-old assumption about the ceiling on this effect in solids, and opens a path to a

new generation of ultra-sensitive temperature sensors, heat detectors, and quantum sensing devices.

Seebeck effect
“When one end of a junction between two dissimilar materials is heated while the other is kept cold, mobile charge carriers drift from the hot side

to the cold side, building up a voltage across the junction. This phenomenon, known as the Seebeck effect, was discovered two centuries ago and underlies technologies ranging from temperature sensors to thermoelectric generators that convert waste heat into electricity,” it said.

It added that for decades, the magnitude of this voltage, quantified as the Seebeck coefficient, has placed an upper bound of only a few millivolts per Kelvin on this effect in a crystalline solid. Most metals generate just tens of microvolts per Kelvin, and even good semiconductors rarely exceed a few hundred microvolts per Kelvin. “Only liquid sys-

tems, such as ionic gels and electrolytes, in which charged ions rather than electrons carry the heat, have been known to cross into the millivolts-per-Kelvin range,” it added.

The scientists have shown that this textbook limit can be shattered in a solid, epitaxial crystal.

The team led by Bivas Saha, along with Renuka Karanje and Dheemahi Rao and colleagues Diksha Dadhich and Sourav Rudra from JNCASR, Ashalatha Indiradevi Kamalasanan Pillai and Magnus Garbrecht from the University of Sydney and Subroto Mukerjee from IISc, grew thin films of scandium nitride (ScN), a refractory transitional-metal nitride, on magnesium oxide substrates

using ultrahigh-vacuum magnetron sputtering.

They deliberately doped them with magnesium to compensate for the material’s naturally occurring free electrons from oxygen dopants.

This produced what is known as a heavily doped, highly compensated (HDHC) semiconductor, a material in which positively and negatively charged dopant atoms are scattered randomly throughout the crystal in nearly equal numbers. “X-ray diffraction and atomic-resolution electron microscopy confirmed that the films remained single-crystalline and epitaxial, with dopant atoms distributed uniformly and no secondary phases or precipitates,” it said.

UNIVERSITY OF AGRICULTURAL SCIENCES,
BANGALORE

Estate Office, GKVK campus, Bangalore-560065

No. EO/TN/16/2026-27

DATED: 28.08.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

(Through e-procurement portal only)

The University of Agricultural Sciences, Bangalore has invited Tender in the prescribed form as per Standard Tender Document KW1 from the registered KPWD/PWD Contractors & Reputed firm for the works SI. No. 1 to 3. The details of the notification, tender document, specifications are available in the website www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in. The cost of tender document is as per e-procurement portal. The EMD has to be paid in the e-procurement portal using e-Procurement payment modes.

The above work is under Two Cover system. The details for two cover system is to be uploaded as per Standard Tender Document.

The Blank Tender Documents can be down loaded from www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Last date and time for uploading is **07-09-2026 upto 4.00 P.M.** The Technical Bid will be opened on **09-09-2026 at 10.30 A.M.** The Financial Bid will be opened on **12-09-2026 at 10.30 A.M.** For more details please contact e-portal help desk at support@eprochelpdesk.com or 8046010000/8068948777 on working days and this office during working hour, Phone No.080-23332765.

Sd/-

Estate Officer

DIPR/CP/2553/NR/2026-27

A BG-BGE

Chicken shops to shut over waste disposal fee

Bengaluru Solid Waste Management Ltd. set to charge ₹5-per-kg service fee for collecting poultry waste generated by meat shops; on an average, each chicken shop generates 35 kg of waste

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Chicken shops across Bengaluru, associated with the Karnataka Poultry Traders’ Association (KPTA), will shut down for two days starting today, to protest against the ₹5-per-kg service fee that Bengaluru Solid Waste Management Ltd. (BSWML) is set to charge for collecting poultry waste generated by meat shops.

The association has demanded that a minimum support price be fixed for poultry waste, arguing that the waste has ‘commercial value’ and is used by private companies to manufacture byproducts and animal feed, which are then sold for profit.

“Waste such as intestines, feathers, skin, and bones is taken by private companies, which process it into powder and use it to make products such as dog and cat food. They earn from these products. At present, middlemen collect the waste from us



Feathers ruffled: The Karnataka Poultry Traders’ Association has argued that private companies should purchase waste from them at a minimum support price. FILE PHOTO

and earn from it, while the companies also make a profit from the final product using our raw material,” the association said.

The association argued that instead of charging shops ₹5 per kg for the waste, private companies should purchase it from them at a minimum support price.

On an average, each chicken shop generates around 32 kg to 35 kg of such waste, the association said.

It also pointed to a tender notification issued by

the Greater Bengaluru Authority (GBA), which states that an authorised service provider has been appointed by BSWML for the scientific collection, transportation and processing of poultry, fish, pig, and other animal waste, including animal bones, generated within the GBA limits.

The notification states that all meat, poultry, fish, pork shops, and other establishments generating animal waste will have to mandatorily pay a service fee of ₹5 per kg for animal

waste and ₹3 per kg for animal bone waste to the authorised service providers. It also requires establishments to hand over the waste only to service providers officially appointed by BSWML.

The association, however, said the fee would add to the costs of chicken shops. It said that if the government does not consider its demand for a minimum support price, shopkeepers would be forced to increase the price of chicken to recover the additional cost.

Bengaluru ranks 17th among world’s top destinations for nightlife

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Bengaluru has been ranked 17th among the world’s best 20 cities for nightlife in 2026, placing it ahead of cities such as Accra, Singapore and Mexico City, according to a survey by *Time Out*. Bengaluru is the only Indian city on the list.

The ranking, published recently, was based on responses from more than 24,000 locals worldwide, who were asked about the quality, affordability, diversity, safety and community feel of nightlife in their cities.

A panel of *Time Out* city editors, culture experts and nightlife specialists also voted on the final rankings.

Bengaluru scored particularly well, with 82% of local respondents saying it is easy to connect with people in the city. The city also received a 71% rating for the quality of its nightlife.

However, affordability emerged as a weaker area, with Bengaluru recording a cumulative 54% score for how affordable it is to go out at night.

According to *Time Out*, Bengaluru’s nightlife is expanding beyond its tradi-



Costly nights: Affordability emerged as a weaker area, with Bengaluru recording a cumulative 54% score for how affordable it is to go out at night. K. MURALI KUMAR

As per *Time Out*, Bengaluru’s nightlife is expanding beyond hotspots such as Indiranagar, M.G. Road and Koramangala

tional hotspots such as Indiranagar, M.G. Road and Koramangala. Neighbourhoods, including Ulsoor, Rajajinagar and Whitefield, are increasingly becoming part of the city’s after-dark circuit, with newer establishments offering cocktails, jazz and intimate, music-focused experiences.

The city continues to retain its longstanding night-

life favourites, with venues such as Pecos, Toit and Biere Club contributing to its established pub and craft-beer culture.

At the same time, newer venues such as Bar Doubble, Dali & Gala, Bar Cameo and Middle Room are adding variety to the scene.

Time Out also highlighted the growth of queer nightlife, pointing to spaces and events such as Dude Party, Kitty Ko and regular drag shows as contributing to a more diverse and inclusive after-dark culture.

Among Bengaluru’s nightlife offerings, street life received the highest local backing at 55%, followed by casual bars at

50%. Bangkok topped the global ranking, followed by Berlin, New York City, Melbourne and São Paulo. Seoul was ranked 16th, immediately ahead of Bengaluru.

Pub city

Welcoming the recognition, Chethan Hegde, owner of 1522, said that Bengaluru’s nightlife has evolved significantly, with several neighbourhoods now offering a range of options.

“I think the ranking is very apt, especially because Bengaluru is widely known as a pub city. The pub culture here is very strong, and almost every locality has become self-sufficient when it comes to nightlife. Bengaluru offers a diverse after-dark experience, with venues catering to different tastes and preferences,” he said.

“We also have establishments that meet global standards, which is certainly something the city can be proud of. It is a feel-good recognition for Bengaluru, even though it may not have an immediate impact on business. I hope the government takes note of this and frames policies that support and encourage the city’s vibrant nightlife culture,” he added.

PM-KUSUM C: Where the sun keeps agricultural pumpsets running

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Narayan Swamy, a farmer from Nallimaradahalli, in Chickballapur district, has given his 40-acre farm land on lease to a private firm for establishing solar panels under PM-KUSUM C project.

This project provides power to agricultural pumpsets instead of relying on Bescom for power supply that gets disrupted owing to overload and other infrastructural issues.

The PM-KUSUM C project is a ‘Government of India’ initiative that solarises existing grid-connected agricultural pumpsets to provide farmers with reliable daytime electricity and zero power disruptions.

Once a mango orchard
Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Narayan Swamy said: “Ear-

lier, I cultivated mangoes along with other fruits on the farm. When the yield started reducing, I felt leasing it was the next best step instead of selling it to a real estate firm. While I get lease amount of ₹60,000 per acre for the next 25 years, thousands of farmers are benefitted from the power generated.” As per Bescom officials, the Nallimaradahalli sub-station provides power to 3,000 farmers’ pumpsets in surrounding 27 villages.

The Hindu visited some of the major project sites of PM-KUSUM C in Bengaluru Rural and Chickballapur region. While Nallimaradahalli 66 kV sub-station in Chickballapur has a capacity of generating 13 MW power, another project, Kundana, generates 3 MW covering 37 villages and powers pumpsets of 797



Bright prospects: The PM-KUSUM C project at Chickballapur district. It is an initiative that solarises existing grid-connected agricultural waterpumps to provide farmers with reliable daytime electricity and zero power disruptions. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

farmers. Similarly, the Devanahalli project generates 13 MW that covers 68 villages powering 2,811 pumpsets.

N. Shivashankar, MD, Bescom, said PM-KUSUM C allows farmers to use

electricity drawn from solar power during the day without power interruption or voltage issues to supply borewell water to their fields. Drawing power from distant hydro or thermal power projects leads

to overloading of transmission lines, resulting in frequent power cuts. Mr. Shivashankar said it required three-and-a-half acres of land to install solar panels to generate one MW.

“The minimum price

In figures

No. of projects	Capacity in MW	Agri pumpsets	IP sets
23	154.33	99	32,499
4	31.59	20	7,138
6	48.56	27	7,996
5	48.92	29	13,098
1	1.96	1	494
4	38.01	18	7,830
43	323.37	194	69,055

Total projects that will be completed before March 2027 in Bescom jurisdiction under PM-KUSUM C



chayats to come forward in identifying such government lands within villages for the project. Similarly, the Kundan and Devanahalli projects are built on Hooganawadi lake, which falls under the Minor Irrigation Department. The private player, Megha Engineering and Infrastructure Ltd. (MIEL), pays prescribed lease amount to the Irrigation Department.

Mr. Shivashankar explained that solar panels are installed at higher levels so that when it rains and the lake overflows, the water does not damage the panels.

Deemed forest land

In order to implement more PM-KUSUM C projects, Mr. Shivashankar also highlighted that Bescom is likely to use portions of deemed forest land in Chickballapur district for the benefit of farmers.

Newcomers at IIMB look to move beyond comfort zones

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Masters of Business Management batch at Indian Institute of Management-Bangalore (IIMB) for the 2026-28 academic year has students from diverse backgrounds, who have challenged themselves in various ways to pursue a dream.

Overcoming challenges

Born in a small village in Bihar, Reema Kumari, 22, is visually challenged. She lost her vision in 2015 when she was 12. “We moved to Noida in Uttar Pradesh in search of better opportunities for studies and medical care. When I lost my vision completely, my family was clueless about the next step. Saksham, an NGO, helped me learn Braille and introduced me to screen reader software, using computer and phone independently. Later, I prepared for IPMAT and CAT,” she said.

After clearing IPMAT, Ms. Kumari joined IIM-



Class act: (From left) Ritika Kapoor, Kunal Jain, Reema Kumari, Abhimanyu Timbadia, and Ramanuja Desikan C.R.

Rohtak for her BBA, an experience that shaped her early understanding of management. “In my third year, I appeared for CAT and secured admissions to IIMB,” she said.

She hopes to gain a meaningful experience in the corporate sector, while also working towards creating opportunities and support systems for children facing similar challenges.

Asserting identity

Kunal Jain, who grew up in Bhagalpur, Bihar, is an openly queer person. He moved to pursue Bachelors in Statistics at Hindu College in Delhi. He observed that studying at Hindu College changed



When I lost my vision completely, my family was clueless about the next step. Saksham, an NGO, helped me learn Braille

REEMA KUMARI
Student with visual impairment

things for him.

“Firstly, I looked for people like me who were doing well in the corporate world. But didn’t find any. Secondly, I started expressing my identity louder. I felt lighter than I had in my life,” he said.

After graduation, Kunal moved to Bengaluru to

work in corporate companies. “I wanted a career in strategy and finance, in the rooms where decisions are made for a greater good and this is what brought me to study at IIMB,” he said.

Reel inspiration

For Ritika Kapoor, the journey to IIMB began, not in a classroom, but on the film production sets. “My entrepreneurial challenge and journey began with independently producing an award-winning short film. Demanding timelines taught me to view every project as a business.”

However, she was left with questions such as why talented teams performed

differently under different leadership, and how organisations navigated uncertainty, and more. “This led me to join MBA and find answers to my questions through classroom debates, diverse perspectives from peers across industries and geographies. The programme is helping me move beyond experience-based intuition towards a more structured understanding of organisations and strategy,” she said.

Major transition

Ramanuja Desikan C.R., also part of the new batch, left the comfort of a Central government job to pursue his passion. He was an

Inspector of Customs at Chennai Customs till May, 2026, and resigned to pursue MBA at IIMB.

“The diversity of people and situations at Customs helped me appreciate the importance of empathy and authority. I learnt that effective administration is not merely about applying rules, but about understanding their impact on different stakeholders, while maintaining integrity and accountability,” he said.

Significant shift

For Abhimanyu Timbadia too, the shift was significant, having studied BA Hons in Philosophy, Politics, and Economics and a postgraduate diploma in Computer Science. He graduated from Ashoka University as a gold medalist. “At Ashoka, I worked on post-quantum cryptography research with the DRDO. This combination of humanistic reasoning plus technical fluency shaped my career choices,” he told *The Hindu*.

PRIME COMMERCIAL OFFICE TOWER FOR SALE, OFF MG ROAD

- Unmissable Opportunity to acquire a premium commercial property in Bengaluru's high-demand core business district. Fully furnished, ready to move in, and high yielding asset. Built-up area: 20,000 sq.ft. Independent Tower/(OC) Received
- Prime Residential Property for Sale, Off Brigade Road, 20,000 sq.ft. with plan sanction.

Contact: +91 91872 24940 / 96060 90858

APPOINTMENT

कोचीन शिपयार्ड लिमिटेड
भारत सरकार की बेची - 1 निविदा कंपनी, पचन, पोत परिवहन और जलमार्ग संस्थान
COCHIN SHIPYARD LIMITED
A Government of India Category-I, Miniratna Company.
Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways

No. CSL/P&A/RECT/CANSRU CONT/NOTIFICATION 11/SP&PO/2026/2 Date: 14.08.2026
CSL AN SHIP REPAIR UNIT(CANSRU), SRI VIJAYA PURAM
REQUIRES SENIOR PROJECT OFFICER/ PROJECT OFFICER ON CONTRACT BASIS

Cochin Shipyards Limited (CSL), a listed premier Mini Ratna Schedule 'A' Company of Govt of India, invites **Online application** for Senior Project Officer/ Project Officer on Contract Basis for CSL AN Ship Repair Unit (CANSRU), Sri Vijaya Puram.

Sl. No.	Name of Posts	No. of Vacancies
1	Senior Project Officer (Safety)	1 Post (UR)
2	Project Officer (Safety)	1 Post (UR)

For more details on **Age, Reservation, Educational Qualification, Experience, Remuneration** etc., please read the vacancy notification on CSL website www.cochinshipyards.in (Career page—CANSRU (ANDAMAN)). Last date of receipt of online application is **14.09.2026**.

“Hindi version of detailed advertisement is published on the website (www.cochinshipyards.in) of CSL.”
Sd/-
GENERAL MANAGER (HR&LD)

SIR: Notices cite errors despite correct info; hearings from Sept. 5

Hearings to continue until Oct. 22, leaving Electoral Registration Officers less than 60 days to conclude cases of 43.8IL voters

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

While the disposal of notices in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls was supposed to begin on August 24 across Karnataka as per the EC's guidelines, Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) in Bengaluru said they generated the notices only on August 28.

Once the process of generating a notice is initiated, it takes a week before a hearing can be held, with the first hearing possible only on the seventh day. In Bengaluru, therefore, hearings can begin only on September 5 – meaning 10 days have already been lost in a process that is already working against a tight deadline.

The hearings will continue until October 22, leaving EROs with less than 60 days to conclude cases involving 43.81 lakh voters across Karnataka. Over 24 lakh of these cases are concentrated in Bengaluru alone.

The tight timeline is also expected to create difficulties for voters in receiving the notices and preparing



The confusion seen during the enumeration phase, when several voters received calls asking them to collect enumeration forms and were unsure whether documents had to be submitted, appears to have persisted into the notice process. FILE PHOTO

documents for the hearings. Booth Level Officers (BLOs) said they received the notices only on Tuesday, while distribution began on Wednesday. Given the volume of notices, they said distribution, in many cases, could continue until Friday – just a day before the hearings begin. “Some people may get enough time, like at least two days, but some may not even get a day. While September 5 was decided as it is a Saturday to cause less inconvenience to the public, this cannot be done each time,” a BLO said.

Karnataka Chief Electo-

ral Officer V. Anbu Kumar, referring to the total number of notices, had said they would be served to voters with logical discrepancies or those whose details, or those of their family members, could not be mapped to the 2002 rolls. However, in several cases, voters who said they had provided the required details in their enumeration forms have also received notices, with the reasons cited not matching the details they had submitted.

For instance, in a notice accessed by *The Hindu*, a 71-year-old man from the Raichur constituency was

issued a notice citing two reasons – that “the age gap between you and another progeny linked with the same parent is less than nine months” and that “the age difference between you and your parent, whose details are used to link you with the rolls prepared during the last SIR, is less than 15 years, that seems to be due to incorrect matching”. However, the elector's first son is 40 years old – born on June 1, 1984, while another son was born on August 26, 1985 – a gap of more than 13 months. Moreover, if the elector's son is the person

whose age creates that discrepancy, then the son should logically be the elector flagged for that particular discrepancy, not the father.

The confusion seen during the enumeration phase, when several voters received calls asking them to collect enumeration forms and were unsure whether documents had to be submitted, also appears to have persisted into the notice process. Several voters said that BLOs had collected documents from them, saying this would “fasten the process” or “reduce discrepancies”. Some said they had received calls on Wednesday asking them to come to the polling station to collect their notices if they wanted them “on time”.

In many other cases, voters said BLOs had already collected documents. The voters, however, said they were unclear about why the documents were being collected or whether they were even required to submit them at this stage.

As per the guidelines, BLOs cannot collect any documents. Documents can be sought during the hearing process.

After missing deadline, part of Pink Line likely to open this month

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

After missing several deadlines, the 7.5-km Kalena Agrahara-Tavarekere stretch of Pink Line is ready for inauguration, with Greater Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda expressing hope that the Centre will approve an inauguration date within September.

Speaking about the new addition to the city's metro network, Mr. Gowda said the stretch is ready to be opened for public use and will be inaugurated once the Government of India provides a date. “We are ready. As soon as the date is given by the Government of India, this stretch will be inaugurated and opened to people for commuting,” he said on Wednesday.

Mr. Gowda had earlier stated that the inauguration would happen in August 2026. This was announced after his first high-level review meeting with senior officials of the Bangalore Metro Rail Corporation Limited (BMRL), after he took over charge of the portfolio.

The Minister had noted that the elevated section of the Pink Line from Kalena



Bengaluru South MP Tejasvi Surya, along with Greater Bengaluru Development Minister Krishna Byre Gowda and BMRL officials, during a trial run of the Namma Metro Pink Line on Wednesday.

Agrahara to Tavarekere was expected to become operational by August 15, 2026, and that the underground stretch from Tavarekere to Nagawara was slated for completion by March 2027. The Pink Line, a 21.3-km corridor connecting Kalena Agrahara in the south to Nagawara in the north, is a crucial component of the metro expansion. Of the total length, 13.8 km runs underground, linking key central areas such as Dairy Circle, M.G. Road, Shivajinagar and Tannery Road, while 7.5 km is elevated. The project has faced repeated delays, missing several deadlines and drawing criticism from commuters. Once operational, the corridor is expected to significantly improve north-

south metro connectivity. “A sufficient number of trains are presently available for commissioning the elevated stretch. The trains are currently undergoing the prescribed trials and testing and are required to complete the mandatory 750-km running before deployment for passenger services. Train operators are identified and their mandatory training is expected to be completed this week,” Mr. Gowda said. BMRL is expecting approval from the Railway Board for the new rolling stock shortly. This will be followed by inspection and authorisation by the Commissioner of Metro Railway Safety for opening the elevated section of the Pink Line for public service.

Juvenile held for posing as IAS officer

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A juvenile has been apprehended for allegedly cheating gullible people by creating fake Facebook accounts in the names of senior IAS and IPS officers and seeking money from victims on various pretexts.

The case came to light after a person from another State was allegedly cheated through a fake Fa-

cebook account created using the name and photograph of Electronics City sub-division DCP Narayan. The accused reportedly sent friend requests to acquaintances and members of the public before approaching them for money.

Following a complaint at Hebbagodi police station, the police launched an investigation and traced the fraud network to Kotakurd village in Rajasthan. A juve-

nile allegedly involved in the racket was taken into custody after his parents were served notice on August 24.

During questioning, the juvenile reportedly told the police that he and his associates had created several fake Facebook accounts in the names of IAS and IPS officers. They allegedly used these accounts to gain the trust of victims and then demand money, citing various rea-

sons. In some instances, the accused allegedly offered household and other items at low prices and collected money from victims. The police recovered ₹2 lakh in cash from the juvenile, suspected to be part of the proceeds of the fraud routed through mule bank accounts.

The juvenile was produced before the Juvenile Justice Board on August 25 and, subsequently, sent to an observation home.

Investment proposals worth ₹29,679 cr. cleared

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The State High-Level Clearance Committee (SHLCC), chaired by Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, on Wednesday approved nine new projects and eight proposals for additional investments, involving a total investment of ₹29,679 crore in the State's industrial sector. These investment pro-

posals are expected to create an additional 66,360 jobs.

The proposals include investment of ₹2,194.94 crore by Vibrancy Renewable Energies, ₹2,300 crore by Mahindra Aerostructures, ₹1,104 crore by Aequs Consumer Products, ₹9,760 crore by Hero Future Energies, ₹1,500 crore by Epsilon, and ₹1,200 crore by Toyota Kirloskar.

GOVERNMENT OF KARNATAKA
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT,
DIVISION, CHITRADURGA

No.EE:PWD:CTA:AE-3:Tender-21:2026-27 Dated:- 02.09.2026

SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

Tenders are invited from registered Contractors in KPWD for the following works through KPPP Portal as per standard tender documents rules.

Name of work :- Head of Account 4059-80-051-0-60-422 SCP:- (1) Construction of C C road in the colonies of scheduled caste, nomadic, semi-nomadic koracha communities of arehalli village mattodu hobli in hosadurga taluk. (PWD/2026-27/RD/WORK_IDENT41050) Estimate Cost Rs. in Lakhs:- 100.00

Tender dates are as mentioned below: Late Date & time for Tender Queries/ Clarifications 09-09-2026 Time: 17.30

Last Date & time for receipt of tenders 10-09-2026 Time: 16.00

Date & time for opening of Technical Bid 11-09-2026 Time: 16.15

Date & time for opening of Financial Bid 15-09-2026 Time: 11.00

Further details can be obtained from this office and H.P. Company helpline Numbers 91 9240214000 and 91 9240214001. The tender details published in the KPP portal are Final.

DIPR/CTA/KSMCA/
306/2026-27

Sd/- Executive Engineer
PWD, Chitradurga.

ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ವಸ್ತುಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರ
ದೊಡ್ಡಕೆರೆ ಮೈನಾನ, ಇಂದಿರಾನಗರ, ಮೈಸೂರು-570010.
ದೂ: 0821-2523626, ಇ-ಮೇಲ್: exhibitionauthority@gmail.com

ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ: ಕವಸ್ತು/ಮುಕಾನಿ/ಗ್ನೋ.ಬೆಂಡರ್/01/2026-27 ದಿನಾಂಕ: 02.09.2026

ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ

ವಿಶ್ವ ವಿಖ್ಯಾತ ಮೈಸೂರು ದಸರಾ-2026ರ ವಸ್ತುಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ ಆಯೋಜನೆ ಮಾಡುವ ವ್ಯವಸ್ಥೆ ಮತ್ತು ನಿರ್ವಹಣೆಗೆ ಸಂಬಂಧಿಸಿದಂತೆ ಎಲ್ಲಾ ಬಾಬುಗಳು ಸೇರ್ಪಡೆ ಮಾಡಿ ಒಟ್ಟಾರೆಯಾಗಿ ಗುತ್ತಿಗೆ ಆಧಾರದ ಮೇಲೆ ಇ-ಪ್ರೊಕ್ಯೂರ್‌ಮೆಂಟ್ ಮುಖಾಂತರ ಅಭ್ಯವಧಿ ಬೆಂಡರ್ ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸಲಾಗಿದೆ. ಬೆಂಡರ್‌ನ ಮೊತ್ತ ರೂ 12,53,00,000/-(18% ಜಿ.ಎಸ್.ಟಿ ಸೇರಿದಂತೆ) ಗಳಾಗಿದ್ದು, ಬೆಂಡರ್ ಅನ್ನು ದಿನಾಂಕ: 16.09.2026ರಂದು ಸಂಜೆ 04:00 ಗಂಟೆಯವರೆಗೆ ಸಲ್ಲಿಸಬಹುದಾಗಿದೆ. ಸದರಿ ಬೆಂಡರ್‌ಗೆ ಸಂಬಂಧಿಸಿದಂತೆ ಹೆಚ್ಚಿನ ವಿವರಗಳು ಬೇಕಾದಲ್ಲಿ ಕಛೇರಿ ವೆಳೆಯಲ್ಲಿ ಕಛೇರಿಯನ್ನು ಸಂಪರ್ಕಿಸುವುದು ಮತ್ತು ವೆಬ್‌ಸೈಟ್ <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> ನಲ್ಲಿ ಮಾಹಿತಿ ಪಡೆಯಬಹುದು ಮೊಬೈಲ್: 8861437181 ಇ-ಮೇಲ್: exhibitionauthority@gmail.com.
Ref. No.: KEA/2026-27/SE0052

Sd/-
ಬೆಂಡರ್ ಆಹ್ವಾನಿಸುವ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರ ಹಾಗೂ
ಸಹಾಯಕ ಕಾರ್ಯಾಲಯ ಅಭಿಯಂತರರು (ಸಿವಿಲ್)
ಕರ್ನಾಟಕ ವಸ್ತುಪ್ರದರ್ಶನ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರ, ಮೈಸೂರು.

DIPR/MYS/64/SA/2026-27

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE PRINCIPAL DISTRICT JUDGE AT
PUDUCHERRY

T.O.P. No. 19 /2026

Union of India, Rep. by Chief Secretary
Government of Puducherry and Another

Petitioners

Vs

1. Mr. Ganesan S/o. Subramanian
2. Puducherry Municipal Services Private Limited
Represented by its Managing Director
3. Reha Environ Private Limited
(Formerly Kiviar Environ Private Limited),
Represented by its Managing Director.

Respondents

Notice to Respondents No. 2 & 3

Sir, please take notice that the Transfer of Original Petition in T.O.P. No. 19/2026 and the stay application in I.A. No. 3/2026 filed by the petitioners above named, on the file of the aforesaid Hon'ble Court stand posted on 10.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M for your appearance either in person or through your counsel and for objections, if any. Your failure to appear on the scheduled date and time would result in deciding the matter in your absence and on the merits of the case.

Sd/-
S. Sridhar B.A., LL.B.
Advocate/Government Pleader
No. 188, Sinna Subraya Pillai Street,
Puducherry-1.

No.187/DIP/AD(PRESS)/ADVT/2026-27

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE PRINCIPAL DISTRICT JUDGE AT
PUDUCHERRY

T.O.P. No. 16 /2026

Union of India, Rep. by Chief Secretary
Government of Puducherry and Another

Petitioners

Vs

1. M/s. SKD Crane Service Earth Movers,
Rep. by its proprietor Mr. Santhosh Kumar
2. Puducherry Municipal Services Private Limited
Represented by its Managing Director
3. Reha Environ Private Limited
(Formerly Kiviar Environ Private Limited),
Represented by its Managing Director.

Respondents

Notice to Respondents No. 2 & 3

Sir, please take notice that the Transfer of Original Petition in T.O.P. No. 16/2026 and the stay application in I.A. No. 2/2026 filed by the petitioners above named, on the file of the aforesaid Hon'ble Court stand posted on 10.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M for your appearance either in person or through your counsel and for objections, if any. Your failure to appear on the scheduled date and time would result in deciding the matter in your absence and on the merits of the case.

Sd/-
S. Sridhar B.A., LL.B.
Advocate/Government Pleader
No. 188, Sinna Subraya Pillai Street,
Puducherry-1.

No.187/DIP/AD(PRESS)/ADVT/2026-27

SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(SOUTH WESTERN RAILWAY CONSTRUCTION ORGANISATION)

NOTIFICATION

Bengaluru, 14th August 2026

S.O. 4547 (E) – In exercise of the powers conferred under clause 37(A) of Section 2 of the Railways Act, 1989 (Act no. 24 of 1989), the Ministry of Railways, (South Western Railway, Construction Organisation, Bengaluru Cantonment) Government of India, hereby notifies that the projects mentioned in the table below are "Special Railway Project" in the State of Andhra Pradesh for providing National Infrastructure for a Public Purpose with effect from the date of publication of the notification in the Official Gazette.

Sl. No.	Name of the Project	Village	Taluk	District
1.	Provision of additional loop line between RD-03 and existing Pilgrim Siding, and Provision of 02 stabling lines on Pilgrim Siding side (03 stabling lines) at Sri Satya Sai Prasanthi Nilayam (SSPN) yard-under the Umbrella Work (PH-16).	Puttaparthi	Puttaparthi	Sri Satya Sai Prasanthi Nilayam

No. W.271/CN/BNC/2026-27/Land SRP/1727
For details log on to: <https://egazette.gov.in>

Sd/-
Pardeep Puri,
Chief Engineer, Construction - III, Bengaluru Cantonment
PUB/423/AAMO/PRB/SWR/2026-27

Download the RailOne app for easy ticket booking, PNR status, and more railway services.

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE PRINCIPAL DISTRICT JUDGE AT
PUDUCHERRY

T.O.P. No. 20 /2026

Union of India, Rep. by Chief Secretary
Government of Puducherry and Another

Petitioners

Vs

1. Mr. Ashok Kumar S/o. Ramalingam
2. Puducherry Municipal Services Private Limited
Represented by its Managing Director
3. Reha Environ Private Limited
(Formerly Kiviar Environ Private Limited),
Represented by its Managing Director.

Respondents

Notice to Respondents No. 2 & 3

Sir, please take notice that the Transfer of Original Petition in T.O.P. No. 20/2026 and the stay application in I.A. No. 3/2026 filed by the petitioners above named, on the file of the aforesaid Hon'ble Court stand posted on 10.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M for your appearance either in person or through your counsel and for objections, if any. Your failure to appear on the scheduled date and time would result in deciding the matter in your absence and on the merits of the case.

Sd/-
S. Sridhar B.A., LL.B.
Advocate/Government Pleader
No. 188, Sinna Subraya Pillai Street,
Puducherry-1.

No.187/DIP/AD(PRESS)/ADVT/2026-27

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE PRINCIPAL DISTRICT JUDGE AT
PUDUCHERRY

T.O.P. No. 18 /2026

Union of India, Rep. by Chief Secretary
Government of Puducherry and Another

Petitioners

Vs

1. M/s. DRA Earth Movers,
Rep. by its proprietor Mr. Ashok Kumar
2. Puducherry Municipal Services Private Limited
Represented by its Managing Director
3. Reha Environ Private Limited
(Formerly Kiviar Environ Private Limited),
Represented by its Managing Director.

Respondents

Notice to Respondents No. 2 & 3

Sir, please take notice that the Transfer of Original Petition in T.O.P. No. 18/2026 and the stay application in I.A. No. 3/2026 filed by the petitioners above named, on the file of the aforesaid Hon'ble Court stand posted on 10.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M for your appearance either in person or through your counsel and for objections, if any. Your failure to appear on the scheduled date and time would result in deciding the matter in your absence and on the merits of the case.

Sd/-
S. Sridhar B.A., LL.B.
Advocate/Government Pleader
No. 188, Sinna Subraya Pillai Street,
Puducherry-1.

No.187/DIP/AD(PRESS)/ADVT/2026-27

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE PRINCIPAL DISTRICT JUDGE AT
PUDUCHERRY

T.O.P. No. 17 /2026

Union of India, Rep. by Chief Secretary
Government of Puducherry and Another

Petitioners

Vs

1. Tennies Prabhu S/o. Mr. Chandrasekaran
2. Puducherry Municipal Services Private Limited
Represented by its Managing Director
3. Reha Environ Private Limited
(Formerly Kiviar Environ Private Limited),
Represented by its Managing Director.

Respondents

Notice to Respondents No. 2 & 3

Sir, please take notice that the Transfer of Original Petition in T.O.P. No. 17/2026 and the stay application in I.A. No. 3/2026 filed by the petitioners above named, on the file of the aforesaid Hon'ble Court stand posted on 10.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M for your appearance either in person or through your counsel and for objections, if any. Your failure to appear on the scheduled date and time would result in deciding the matter in your absence and on the merits of the case.

Sd/-
S. Sridhar B.A., LL.B.
Advocate/Government Pleader
No. 188, Sinna Subraya Pillai Street,
Puducherry-1.

No.187/DIP/AD(PRESS)/ADVT/2026-27

SC/ST quota medical seats in State see a sharp decline

This is a result of the Karnataka government reverting to the earlier reservation quantum for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, with cases against the increased reservation in recruitment being heard in the High Court

Sharath S. Srivatsa
BENGALURU

As Karnataka has reverted to the earlier reservation quantum for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, with cases against the increased reservation in recruitment being heard in the High Court of Karnataka, the number of medical seats for these communities has seen a decline.

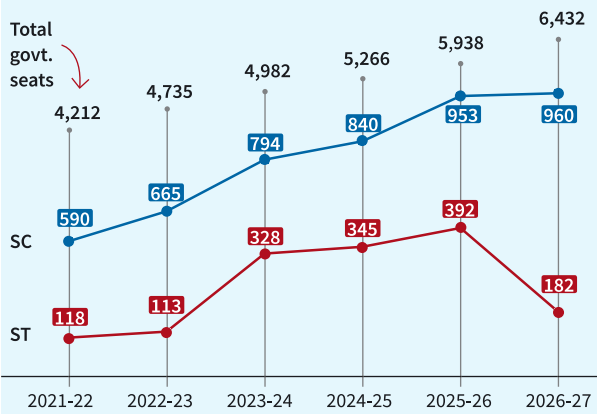
As against 953 reserved seats for SCs and 392 for STs of the total 5,609 government seats in 2025-2026, the SC and ST reserved seats has come down to 906 and 182, respectively, of the total 6,045 in 2026-2027.

After the Karnataka Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Reservation of Seats in Educational Institutions and of Appointments or Posts in the Services under the State) Act, 2022, came into effect, SC and ST students had 17% and 7% reservation, respectively, since the 2023-2024 academic year. However, with the High Court hearing the case pertaining to recruitment, the government reverted to the earlier 15% and 3% for SC and ST communities, respectively, from the 2026-2027 academic year.

The community estimates that with the reduc-



Medical seat quota for SC/ST



tion, STs are set to lose about 2,800 posts while SCs will lose about 1,400 in the ongoing recruitment, though the government has said that this number of posts will be kept in abeyance till the court ruling.

This follows a recent government decision to reduce the reservation after it started one of the largest recruitment drives with about 72,000 vacancies to be filled. In 2022, the then BJP government – based on recommendations from

the H.N. Nagamohan Das Commission – had increased the SC reservation to 17% and the ST reservation to 7% based on their population. This led to an increase in the overall reservation to 56%, breaching the 50% cap set by the Supreme Court.

Acknowledging the decline, Minister for Scheduled Tribes Welfare T. Raghuramurthy said that the government will wait for the Karnataka High Court ruling on the matter. “We are hopeful of a judgment in favour of increased reservation and it is expected to come soon. Several other States have given reservation based on population of SCs and STs. It is a fundamental right,” the Minister told *The Hindu*.

Former Chairperson of Karnataka State Commission for Backward Classes Ravi Varma Kumar has been leading the legal efforts, he said, adding that there have been efforts from community leaders too in the legal battle. Mr. Raghuramurthy said that the Congress government has written to the Centre to include the enhanced reservation in the 9th Schedule of the Constitution, which would provide constitutional protection.

Govt. will wait for HC ruling, says Minister

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Minister for Scheduled Tribes Welfare T. Raghuramurthy said that the government will wait for the Karnataka High Court ruling on the matter. “We are hopeful of a judgment in favour of increased reservation and it is expected to come soon. Several other States have given reservation based on population of SCs and STs. It is a fundamental right,” the Minister told *The Hindu*.

Former Chairperson of Karnataka State Commission for Backward Classes Ravi Varma Kumar has been leading the legal efforts, he said, adding that there have been efforts from community leaders too in the legal battle.

Mr. Raghuramurthy said that the Congress government has written to the Centre to include the enhanced reservation in the 9th Schedule of the Constitution, which would provide constitutional protection.

Asked what was causing the delay, he said, “We feel that the BJP is delaying the process.”

Siddaramaiah backs campus Shudra Seva Sanghas to nurture new OBC leadership

Nagesh Prabhu
BENGALURU

With nearly 65% of the population below the age of 35 and the demographic dividend increasingly figuring in political discourse, former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah is backing the formation of Shudra Seva Sanghas in universities and colleges across Karnataka to draw young people from Other Backward Classes (OBCs) into public life and help develop a new generation of political leaders.

The initiative assumes significance against the backdrop of the growing visibility of Gen Z-led protests in the country and concerns within political parties over the declining participation of young people, in conventional politics.

Mr. Siddaramaiah recently inaugurated a Shudra Seva Sangha in Bengaluru, and attended the sangha meetings with the objective of involving students belonging to OBCs in social and political activities and nurturing leadership qualities among them.

According to the organisers, young graduates have been appointed as office-bearers at district and taluk levels to facilitate the formation of sanghas in colleges and universities across the State. B.R. Rame Gowda, chairman of *Shudra Shakti*, a newspaper, and Congress leader Mura-



Former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah inaugurating Shudra Seva Sangha in Bengaluru. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

lidhar Halappa have been appointed president and convener, respectively, of the State-level Shudra Seva Sangha.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Halappa said Mr. Siddaramaiah had promised the organisation of his support for setting up sanghas and conducting activities across the State with the aim of creating leadership opportunities for youth from backward classes.

The organisation also seeks to challenge the dominance of established political families and money power in politics by creating an alternative leadership pool among young people from backward communities, he said.

Initially, the sanghas plan to take up issues directly affecting students, including hygiene and basic facilities in hostels, toilets, transport, sports infrastructure, issuance of caste and income certi-

icates, admissions, and access to coaching for the IAS and KAS examinations.

The organisers also plan to hold awareness programmes, camps and discussions to encourage greater political and civic participation among students.

They believe young people are often discouraged from entering politics by parents and teachers, who tend to view political involvement as a distraction from education and a less stable career option.

At meetings with the organisers, Mr. Siddaramaiah is learnt to have emphasised that the youth should be treated as a demographic asset and not merely as an electoral constituency. The initiative could potentially help the Congress build a new generation of leaders while strengthening its social base ahead of the 2028 Assembly election.

BJP seeks sacking of two Ministers

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A recent letter to Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar by Congress MLA Ashok Kumar Rai, accusing two engineers of Karnataka Rural Infrastructure Development Limited of collecting extra charges from contractors stating that it has to be given to the Dakshina Kannada district in-charge Minister and the department Minister, has now taken a serious turn with the BJP urging the Chief Minister to sack them.

Addressing a press conference in Bengaluru on Wednesday, Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly R. Ashok also urged the

government to hand over the investigation to CBI.

In the letter, Mr. Rai has stated that an extra 7% of money is being collected from contractors in KRIDL, allegedly to be given to these Ministers and that contractors who questioned it are being threatened.

Mr. Ashok alleged that after the Congress came to power, officials were acting in an unruly manner.

“If ₹100 is released, only ₹30 worth of work is done. The remaining 70% goes as commission. When we made the allegation, they asked for documents. Now a Congress MLA himself has spoken about the commission,” he said.

Congress slams FIR against Rahul, says BJP trying to stifle Opposition voices

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Stating that the BJP was attempting to stifle Opposition voices, the Congress held a protest in Bengaluru on Wednesday against the FIR filed against Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi in Uttarakhand.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said at the protest, “It is our duty to create awareness among the people the path in which the country is moving. We are living in a democracy, but pellets were fired during the youth protest and the Centre was unable to respond to questions. The Su-



Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, KPCC president B.K. Hariprasad, and former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah during a protest in Bengaluru on Wednesday. SUDHAKARA JAIN

preme Court had to intervene.”

Former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah termed the FIR as a “grave injustice” and an insult to the Consti-

tution. “Mr. Gandhi had questioned purification ritual held at the stage from which Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge had addressed at Haldwani in Ut-

tarakhand. There is no place for untouchability in the Constitution. What wrong has he done?” he asked.

Terming the FIR as a black spot in democracy, Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president B.K. Hariprasad urged the Youth Congress and NSUI workers to stage protests in front of BJP offices and stage black flag protest to BJP leaders. “Constitution has to be protected. When we failed, the Gen Z stopped Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah. If you don't do it, the country's future will not be secure,” he said.

HC to examine Governor’s appeal on power to suspend KPSC chief

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The High Court of Karnataka on Wednesday issued notice to suspended KPSC chairperson Shivashankarappa S. Sahukar on an appeal by the Special Secretary to the Governor challenging a single judge's recent ruling that the Governor could not suspend the chairperson, even in urgent circumstances, without the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers, and that post facto approval by the Council was invalid.

A Division Bench comprising Chief Justice Vibhu Bakhru and Justice K.S. Hemalekah adjourned further hearing till December 2.

The single judge erred by invalidating the July 10 suspension for lack of prior “aid and advice” from the Council of Ministers, it was contended in the appeal, while pointing

out that the urgent action was justified as the chairperson's alleged failure to disclose his daughters' participation in KPSC recruitment had triggered public outrage, threatening the commission's credibility.

Relying on the doctrine of ratification, it has been pointed out in the appeal that the Council of Ministers formally approved the Governor's action of suspension on July 19. Citing a Supreme Court ruling, the appellant maintained that subsequent ratification validates the original action and dates back to its issuance, effectively curing any procedural infirmity as there was no conflict between the decision of the Governor and the Council of Ministers.

It has been pointed out in the appeal that allowing continuation of the single judge's interpretation would have dire consequences as it would

“seriously impair the functioning” of constitutional bodies and “substantially dilute” the Governor's power under Article 317(2) of the Constitution to act decisively against the chairperson or members of State public service commissions when an institution's integrity is at stake. The single judge on August 18 set aside the Governor's July 10 order of suspending Mr. Sahukar while giving liberty to the Governor to take a decision with the aid and advice of the Council of Minister.

Fresh order

Though the Governor had passed a fresh order suspending Mr. Sahukar after the single judge's order, the present appeal has been filed challenging the interpretation of law by the single judge in holding that the Governor cannot act independently under Article 317(2).

TAMIL NADU LIVESTOCK DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
IV Floor, Integrated Office Complex for Animal Husbandry & Fisheries Department,
571, Anna Salai, Saidapet Veterinary Polyclinic Campus, Nandanam P.O., Chennai - 35. e-mail: tnld2016@gmail.com

e-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders are invited from eligible tenderers online through <https://tntenders.gov.in> for the following item under “Two part System”

e-tender Ref. No	Name of the Item	Quantity (Nos.)
80/2026	Power-Driven Chaff cutters	3000
81/2026	Genset for Walk-in-Coolers	60
82/2026	Livestock Insurance Services for animals under Free Milk Cow Distribution Scheme and Vetri Magalir Goat Rearing Scheme.	1,60,000 Animals

Individual tender documents with full details can be downloaded at free of cost from <https://tntenders.gov.in> upto **05.10.2026, 11.00 am**
Last date for submission of tenders: **05.10.2026, 11.00 am**
Corrigendum/Addendum to this publication, if any, would appear only on the above website.

DIPR/2751/TENDER/2026**Chief Executive Officer**

Government of Odisha
Office of Special Relief Commissioner
NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
No. 4797 / R&DM(DM), Dt. 02.09.2026

The Office of the Special Relief Commissioner, Government of Odisha, invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from reputed, technically competent and experienced Agencies/ Firms/ System Integrators having proven experience in Early Warning Dissemination Systems, Public Warning Systems, Emergency Communication Systems, Mass Notification Systems and Disaster Management Communication Technologies for Selection Agency for Establishment, Upgradation, Integration, Operation and Maintenance of Early Warning Dissemination System (EWDS) in the State.

- Detailed document with terms & conditions of EOI can be downloaded from <https://srcodisha.nic.in>
- Last date for submission of EOI : 25th September, 2026 by 15:00 Hrs
- Mode of Submission of EOI : Online via email : srcodishagov@gmail.com/ Sealed hardcopy to the following address in Registered Post.

Address :
Office of the Special Relief Commissioner, Rajiv Bhawan, Unit-5, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, Pin-751001.**Special Relief Commissioner**

24001/436/2627**OIPR-24001/24003/1/26-27/0003**

BANGALORE DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
T. Chowdiah Road, Kumara Park West, Bengaluru - 560 020

No.: BDA/E.E.(E)/530/2026-27**Date: 02.09.2026**

SHORT-TERM TENDER NOTICE
Short-Term Tender for electricity related works is invited by Bangalore Development Authority (Indent Number: BDA/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT278. Tender Schedule is as below.
Tender Schedule: (1) Date of availability of Tender Documents in e-portal: **03.09.2026** (2) Last date and time for submission of Tender: **09.09.2026, 17.00 Hrs.** (3) Date of opening Technical Bid of Tender: **10.09.2026 at 17.10 Hrs.** (4) Date of opening Financial Bid of Tender: **Refer e-proc.** Interested contractors can view further details on <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> and for more details it is requested to contact the Electrical Division of BDA during office hours.
Note: For any reason if there is delay in uploading the Tender Documents in e-portal, the revised/modified Tender Schedule will only be published in e-portal.
Sd/- Executive Engineer (Electrical), Electrical Division, BDA, Bengaluru.

BEFORE THE HON'BLE III ADDITIONAL SENIOR CIVIL JUDGE (III ASCJ), BENGALURU RURAL, AT BENGALURU
OS No. 1805/2024

BETWEEN:
SMT. DEEPTI SINGH, D/O SRI. DEEWAN SINGH, AGED ABOUT 45 YEARS, R/O: RH-06, RAJINI ASHISH APARTMENT, NO. 58/1, THUBARAHALLI, VARTHUR, BENGALURU- 560066PLAINTIFF
AND:
SRI. BHUPENDRA SINGH CHAHAR, S/O SRI. LAXMAN SINGH CHAHAR, AGED ABOUT 43 YEARS, R/O: 37A/306C, DURGANAGAR, DAYAL BAGH, AGRA- 282005DEFENDANT

NOTICE
Whereas the above-named Plaintiff has instituted the suit bearing O.S. No. 1805/2026 against you, Mr. Bhupendra Singh Chahar, S/o Sri. Laxman Singh Chahar, aged about 43 years, R/o: 37A/306C, Durganagar, Dayal Bagh, Agra-282005 seeking declaration in respect of the schedule property.
And whereas summons issued to you through ordinary process and by Registered Post Acknowledgment Due have returned unserved, and this Hon'ble Court has, by order dated **19.08.2026**, been pleased to permit service of summons on you by way of paper publication under **Order V Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908:**
You are hereby required to appear before this Hon'ble Court in person or through a duly instructed advocate on **12.11.2026 at 11:00 A.M.**, and to file your written statement, failing which the suit shall be heard and determined **ex parte** in your absence, and you shall have no further notice of these proceedings.

SCHEDULE A PROPERTY
All that piece and parcel of residentially converted land bearing BBMP No. 684 (carved out of the clubbed property of vendor Nos. 1 and 2 both in survey No. 57), Ward No. 85, situated at Tuberahalli Village, Varthur Hobli, Bangalore East Taluk, measuring 1 Acre and 21 Guntas, and bounded by:
East by : Survey No. 56
West by : Survey No. 65/3 belonging to Vendor No. 1
North by : Survey No. 36
South by : Survey No. 58
The Schedule A property comprises of following two items:
Item No. 1:
All that piece and parcel of residentially converted land bearing portion of BBMP khata No. 694 (carved out of Survey No. 57), Ward No. 85, situated at Tuberahalli village, Varthur Hobli, Bangalore East Taluk, measuring 20 Guntas, and bounded by:
East by : Item No. 2
West by : Survey No. 65/3 belonging to Vendor No. 1
North by : Survey No. 37
South by : Survey No. 53
Item No. 2:
All that piece and parcel of residentially converted land bearing portion of BBMP khata No. 711 (carved out of Survey No. 57), Ward No. 85, situated at Tuberahalli village, Varthur Hobli, Bangalore East Taluk, measuring 1 Acre 1 Gunta, and bounded by:
East by : Land bearing Survey No. 56
West by : Item No. 1
North by : Survey No. 37
South by : Survey No. 53
SCHEDULE B PROPERTY
(property conveyed under this deed)
An undivided 1.48% share (equivalent to 968 square feet) in the land comprised in the Schedule A Property.
SCHEDULE C PROPERTY
(description of the row house constructed by the purchasers through the Developer under separate Construction Agreement)
A residential Row House bearing No. RH-06 in "Rajni Ashish Rose", constructed on the Schedule A property with a super built up area of 16225 square feet along with all the common proportionate rights in the common amenities and facilities in proportion to the undivided share conveyed hereunder.
Given under my hand and the seal of the Court.

Advocate: M/S Saaksha Legal,
M 04-05, Shree Complex, No. 73,
St. Johns Road, Bengaluru - 560 042

Deputy Registrar,
III Additional Senior Civil Judge,
Bengaluru Rural, Bengaluru

BY THE ORDER OF COURT



The partnership will facilitate evidence-based psychological support, including psychometric assessments, psychotherapy, counselling and rehabilitative counselling for prisoners. THE HINDU

NIMHANS, prisons dept. sign MoU to strengthen inmates' mental healthcare

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Department of Prisons and Correctional Services, Karnataka, has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the National Institute of Mental Health and Neurosciences (NIMHANS), Bengaluru, to strengthen mental health support and research among incarcerated individuals.

Under the collaboration, a multidisciplinary team of mental health professionals from NIMHANS will conceptualise and implement programmes aimed at addressing psychological and mental health concerns among inmates. The initiatives are also expected to strengthen the research wing of the Central Prison in Bengaluru.

The partnership will facilitate evidence-based psychological support, including psychometric as-

sessments, psychotherapy, counselling and rehabilitative counselling for prisoners. Specialised workshops will also be conducted to promote psychological well-being in correctional facilities.

The MoU seeks to raise awareness and conduct sensitisation programmes on mental health, along with periodic batch-wise psychosocial training focusing on suicide prevention and the perils of substance use.

The collaboration will also seek to strengthen existing Tele-MANAS services and facilitate communication and visits between inmates and their families to improve social support and family connectedness.

Another key component is facilitating authorised research by PhD scholars of NIMHANS, subject to institutional, ethical, legal and administrative requirements.

Agniveer involvement ruled out in military weapon theft

Military Intelligence has joined the investigation into the missing service weapons from 20 Madras Regiment premises in Secunderabad; probe being conducted from an undisclosed location

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

The Malkajigiri Police have reportedly ruled out the involvement of Agniveers in the theft of service weapons and ammunition from the 20 Madras Regiment premises in Bollaram, Secunderabad Cantonment, even as the investigation continues under heightened secrecy inside the defence area.

Military Intelligence has also joined the investigation into the theft, with the probe being conducted from within the defence area at an undisclosed location to maintain confi-



Missing gear: The stolen service weapons include four AK-203 assault rifles and six 9mm pistols. IMAGE FOR REPRESENTATION

dentiality. Sources said even staff at the Bollaram Police Station were not aware of the status of the investigation or the details of the probe.

The restrictions on shar-

ing information come amid heightened security following the theft of four AK-203 assault rifles, an INSAS IBI rifle, six 9 mm Auto 1A pistols and a civilian 6.35-bore pistol from the

Army premises. A passive night-vision binocular and more than 1,800 rounds of ammunition were also reported missing.

The discrepancy was detected around 7.50 a.m. on Monday when the Kote and Battalion Magazine was opened and the locks were found broken. The weapons and ammunition were last physically accounted for around 6 p.m. on August 30.

The Army subsequently reverified its weapon and ammunition holdings and accounting records, searched authorised storage areas and adjoining premises and checked issue and receipt registers.

ICF-Chennai gets order for 51 rakes for Bengaluru suburban rail project from K-RIDE

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Bengaluru Suburban Rail Project (BSRP) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Integral Coach Factory (ICF), Chennai, for the manufacture and supply of 51 rakes comprising three-car trainsets.

The MoU was signed at ICF in Chennai on Tuesday in the presence of K-RIDE/Bi-RIDE Managing Director Lakshman Singh, and ICF



The work order covers the design, manufacture, inspection, testing, and commissioning of the coaches.

General Manager Manish Agarwal.

The work order covers

the design, manufacture, inspection, testing, and commissioning of the coaches.

It also includes obtaining statutory approvals from the Research Designs and Standards Organisation (RDSO), system integration, and compliance with Reliability, Availability, Maintainability, and Safety (RAMS) requirements.

According to officials, the procurement of rolling stock is an important com-

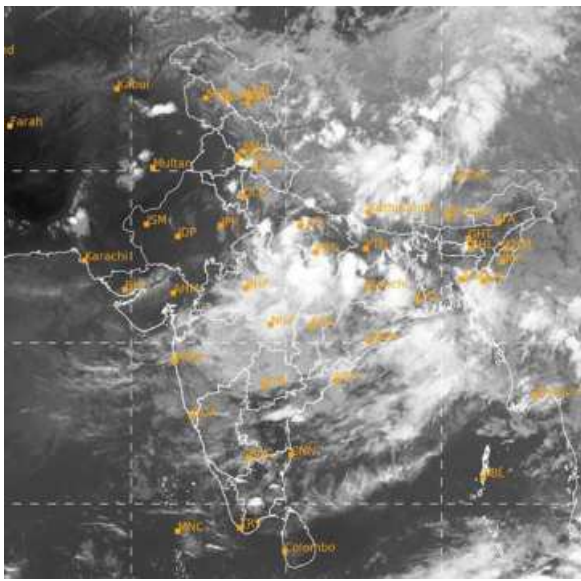
ponent of the project, which aims to establish an efficient suburban rail network connecting Bengaluru with surrounding areas.

Milestone

Mr. Singh said, "The MoU marked a significant milestone in the implementation of the project. The procurement of modern rolling stock would help strengthen efforts to establish a safe, reliable and sustainable suburban rail network."

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, Sub Himalayan West Bengal, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh and Vidarbha

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		31.5	25.5	Kurnool		36.3	26.3
Ahmedabad		0.4	34.4	Lucknow		35	30.5
Aizawl		24.5	29.2	Madurai		39.5	27.1
Bengaluru		30.4	20.7	Mangaluru		3	30.9
Bhopal		27.6	23.2	Mumbai		4.5	31.5
Bhubaneswar		34.2	26.1	Mysuru		32.0	18.8
Chandigarh		34.7	25.9	New Delhi		31.3	28.0
Chennai		37.2	28.6	Patna		34.4	29.9
Coimbatore		34.0	22.6	Port Blair		7.4	31.2
Dehradun		7.6	29.9	Prayagraj		47.1	29.0
Gangtok		19	20.3	Puducherry		36.4	27.8
Goa		10	31.4	Pune		30.0	22.8
Guwahati		6	32.5	Raipur		1.4	29.0
Hubballi		28.0	21.0	Ranchi		40	26.7
Hyderabad		6	32.2	Shillong		9.2	22.8
Imphal		3.8	26.9	Shimla		42.8	21.8
Jaipur		34.8	26.8	Srinagar		0.3	29.6
Kochi		3.8	26.0	Thiruvananthapuram		33.0	24.5
Kohima		27	32.0	Tiruchirappalli		40.1	27.6
Kolkata		33.4	25.5	Vijayawada		33.2	27.0
Kozhikode		33.4	25.5	Visakhapatnam		33.8	28.4

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM2.5	PM10
Ahmedabad	23	36	20	81	101
Bengaluru	23	17	58	115	132
Chennai	6	14	52	46	61
Delhi	25	43	49	67	146
Hyderabad	11	17	26	79	77
Kolkata	6	29	40	227	192
Lucknow	7	17	50	32	30
Mumbai	4	10	15	26	84
Pune	10	18	75	28	54
Visakhapatnam	7	17	50	32	30

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

KARNATAKA STATE BEVERAGES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
4th Floor, TTMC Building "A" Block, K.H.Road, Shanthinagar, Bengaluru - 560027. Ph: 22483636/38/39
Fax: 22483645/22113106

No:HR-14013/2/2021 **Date:02.09.2026**

TENDER NOTIFICATION
Karnataka State Beverages Corporation Limited has invited e-tender under Two Cover System for providing Security Guard services for a period of 1 year. Companies/agencies providing human resources services with an audited account for at least 03 financial years are eligible to participate in the e-tender through the Karnataka Government's e-procurement platform. The Interested companies/Agencies may participate by due registration in Karnataka Procurement Portal (KPPP) of the Government of Karnataka. The Calendar of events is as follows:

Particulars	Date & Time
Issue of Tender Notification	Tender No: KSBCL/2026-27/SE0044 Dated: 28.08.2026
Pre-Bid Meeting	07.09.2026 at 11:30 am
Venue of Pre-Bid Meeting	KSBCL, Board Room, 4th Floor, TTMC "A" Block, BMTC Building, Shanthi Nagar, Bengaluru - 560027
Last date and time for submission of Bid	28.09.2026 at 5:30 pm
Opening of Technical Bid	30.09.2026 at 10:30 am
Opening of Financial Bid	03.10.2026 at 10:30 am onwards

For more details, visit the website <http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>
Sd/-
For Executive Director (Admin & Infra)

DIPR/CP/2582/OCL/2026-27

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDER (only through KPP Portal)
BWSSB invites tenders in two stage tender system from eligible contractors for the following works.

Sl. No.	Name of the Works	Amount Put to Tender EMD Amount
Office of the Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT), 9th floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K G Road, Bangalore -09		
IFT NO. BWSSB/CE(D&QA)/ACE(D)/TA/1305/2026-27 Date: 01.09.2026		
1.	Work of Construction of Service Station Building at Nellurahalli Lake & Hoodi GLR coming under EE(E-1) Division, Bengaluru.	Rs.1,82,11,995.31 Rs.2,73,200/-
2.	Work of Construction of Sub Division office at Bellandur for AEE(E-1-3), Bengaluru.	Rs.1,90,14,285/- Rs.2,85,300/-
3.	Work of Construction of Division office at R.T. Nagar, Bengaluru.	Rs.1,62,79,622/- Rs.2,44,194/-

For all the above works last date & time for receipt of tenders: **16.09.2026 upto 16.00 hrs.**
Technical bids will be opened on **17.09.2026 at 16.00 hrs.**
Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Design, QA & IT)

The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-Procurement process can be obtained by logging on to <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> For further details contact the above signed office during working hours

DIPR/CP/2570/MAA/2026-27

District Urban Development Cell, Deputy Commissioner Office, Hassan District.

Telephone No: 08172-234839 Email:pdhassandudc@gmail.com
No:Mun(3)CR/78/(Part-1 to 4)/2026-27 Date: 02-09-2026

: TENDER NOTIFICATION :

The tender is invited in two cover system by using KW-3 & KC-4 standard document from eligible contractors and registered firms for different works to be carried out and service to be provided during Hassanamba Temple Jatra Mahotsava-2026. The detail of works and service to be carried is as below:-
Sl.No.Indent No in KPPP portal 1.DMA/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT 62054 Description of Work PROVIDING LIGHTING ARRANGEMENT ALL AROUND HASSAN CITY INCLUDING TEMPLE AND MAGER CIRCLES OF HASSAN TOWN FOR HASANAMBA JATRA MAHOSTAVA 2026 Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST) (Rs.in Lakhs)83.05 2.DMA/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT62055 Description of Work PRINTING AND SUPPLYAING DIFFERENT ITEMS AND OTHER WORKS FOR HASANAMBA JATRA MAHOSTAVA FOR THE YEAR 2026 Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST) (Rs.in Lakhs)71.92 3.DMA/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT62056 Description of Work SUPPLYING, INSTALLING AND MAINTENING OF MOBILE TOILETS FOR HASANAMBA JATRA MAHOSTAVA 2026 Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST) (Rs.in Lakhs)67.53 4.DMA/2026-27/SE8414 Description of Work APPOINTMENT OF CLEANING EMPLOYES FOR HASANAMBA JATRA MAHOSTAVA 2026 Amount put to Tender (Excluding GST) (Rs.in Lakhs)7.82 Interested contractors and Firms shall register on the e-procurement platform to participate in this tender. Contractors and Firms can download the tender documents from the E-Procurement platform (www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in). Tenders shall be submitted electronically at www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in EMD and Tenders Processing Fee shall also be paid electronically. The calendar of events & other information is as following:-
Calendar of Events and other information Indent No in KPPP portal DMA/2026-27/EL/WORK_INDENT62054 Earnest Money Deposit Rs. 1.66 Lakhs Last Date for submitting of completed tender documents in KPPP-portal 19-09-2026 Opening date of Technical bid 21-09-2026 DMA/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT62055 Earnest Money Deposit Rs. 1.35 Lakhs Last Date for submitting of completed tender documents in KPPP-portal 19-09-2026 Opening date of Technical bid 21-09-2026 DMA/2026-27/SE8414 Earnest Money Deposit Rs.0.20 Lakhs Last Date for submitting of completed tender documents in KPPP-portal 19-09-2026 Opening date of Technical bid 21-09-2026 Any changes in the tender conditions and postponement of calendar of events (if any) is notified only through e-Procurement portal and will not be published in any newspapers.

Sd/- Project Director,
District Urban Development Cell, Hassan.

ಚಾಸಾಸಂಯುಜಿಸುವ/ಚಾಸಸ/458/ಕೆಎಎಎಂಎಂಎ/2026-27

BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED
(Wholly Owned by Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
(CIN-U04010KA2002SGC030438)

BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION (Through KPP portal)
Providing Electrical infrastructure to the regularized IP sets by extending 11 KV lines, Erection of 25 KVA Star 1 (4 Star) rated Distribution Transformers and Extension of LT line on Partial Turnkey basis (25 KVA Distribution Transformers will be supplied by BESCOM) under item wise fixed price contract on PERCENTAGE QUOTING BASIS.
Tenders No's for Others : **BESCOM/2025-2026/EL/WORK_INDENT 1022, 1032, 1033, & 1036/Call-3**
Time Schedule:(1) Availability of Bid documents :**03-09-2026 @ 17:00** Hrs onwards. (2) Last date for submission of Queries: **08-09-2026** before **17:00** Hrs. (3) Pre-Bid meeting: **10-09-2026 @ 11:00** Hrs. (4) Pre-Bid meeting Venue: Office of Chief Engineer(Ele), O&M Zone, BESCOM, Turuvanur Road, Opp RTO Office, Chitradurga. (5) Last date for bid submission: **19-09-2026 @ 17:00** Hrs. (6) Opening of Technical Bids: **21-09-2026 @ 11:00** Hrs.
The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the KPP portal from the website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> / E-procurement Help Desk: Phone No: 9240214000 & 9240214001 E-mail: support@eprochelpdesk.com
Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on KPP portal. Bidders can take the assistance from the e-procurement during working hours.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Ele), O&M Zone, BESCOM, Chitradurga

For electricity related complaints Call: 1912
Download BESCOM Mithra Mobile APP

DEPARTMENT OF MINORITY WELFARE
No.16C, Miller Tank Bed Area, Vasantha Nagara, Bengaluru - 560 052.
Telephone: 080-22535901/918/Helpline: 8277799990

Notification
No: MWD/D/HOSTEL AD/CR-05/2026-27 **Date: 31.08.2026**

Online applications are invited for the Post-metric hostels (Professional and Post Graduation courses only) of Minority Welfare Department.

Online Applications are invited for admission into Minority post-metric boys/girls hostels(Professional and Post graduation course students only) in the Minority Welfare Department for the year of 2026-27th from the students of minority community(Muslim, christian, jain, sikh, buddha and parsi students and belonging to other castes(Sc, St & other backward caste) of the Karnataka.
• Students are advised to apply online for this link <https://shp.karnataka.gov.in>
• **Online applications Start date is 03.09.2026 & Last date to apply online for Minority Post-metric hostels(Professional and Post graduation course students only) is 30.09.2026.**
• Student's family annual income should not exceed **Rs.2.50 Lakhs.**
• Districtwise and Taluk-wise Minority hostels details and eligibility for admission & documents to be submitted details Visit : <https://dom.karnataka.gov.in>
• In case of technical difficulties while applying online application you can contact through **Email:directorgokdom@gmail.com OR visit Website: <https://dom.karnataka.gov.in>**

Sd/-
Director
Directorate of Minorities, Bengaluru.

DIPR/CP/2568/MAA/2026-27

THE HUTTI GOLD MINES COMPANY LIMITED
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
Hutti - 584 115, Raichur Dist., Karnataka State. Ph: (08537)276339/275463
e-Mail: material276339@gmail.com website: www.huttigold.karnataka.gov.in

TENDER NOTIFICATION NO.19/26-27DT: 03.09.2026 (Through KPP Portal only)

Tender is invited by "The I/c. Dy. General Manager (Materials)" for the following Tenders as detailed below

Sl.No.	Description	EMD in Rs.
1	Procurement of Pneumatic operated Hopper loader. HGML/2026-27/IND0548	1,00,000/-
2	Procurement of Refilling Oxygen DA Medical Jumbo Medical Oxygen small Cylinders for Industrial Medical dept use. HGML/2026-27/IND0481/CALL-2	38,000/-
3	Procurement of Sports items for HGML Institute. HGML/2026-27/IND0482/CALL-3	25,000/-
4	Supply of guy wire. HGML/2026-27/IND0543	35,000/-
5	Supply of Conveyor Belt Rollers and Frames for UG crusher. HGML/2026-27/IND0545	70,000/-
6	Repair of Bituminous Road in HGML Hospital. HGML/2025-26/RD/WORK_INDENT136/CALL-3	25,500/-
7	Electrical Poles painting, tree branches clearance and concreting work in HGML Colony. HGML/2026-27/OW/WORK_INDENT145/CALL-2	13,000/-
8	Providing Manpower (10 persons) Unloading & Loading Works at Main Stores, Hutti Gold Mines. HGML/2026-27/SE0095/CALL-2	48,000/-
9	AMC for Computers and Printers. HGML/2026-27/SE0102	47,000/-
10	Procurement of MS Steel Items for General use. HGML/2026-27/IND0540	2,14,500/-

Calendar of Events: (1) Pre-Bid Meetings (Zoom): 09.09.2026 for Sl.No.10 at 11.00 A.M. (2) Last date for receipt of tender: 19.09.2026 at 4.00 P.M. (3) Opening of Technical Bid on: 21.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M.
For further details interested bidders are advised to log on to website <https://www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in> or contact the office of undersigned during working hours. For participating in the above tender bidder needs to be registered in KPP portal.

Sd/- The I/c Deputy General Manager (Materials)

LEADING GOLD PRODUCER IN INDIA



Orthodoxy redux

Religion is oft used as a tool to suppress women in the public sphere

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar’s directive to restrict Muslim women’s participation in public celebrations has unsettled Keralam because it strikes at a fundamental question: women’s right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad’s 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can intrude into the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to caution against such departures. That argument holds no weight. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to conform to the values enshrined in the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause “chaos”, the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is at variance with constitutional equality and Keralam’s long struggle to expand the space in public life for women disadvantaged by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a monolith. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a counter-current of renewed orthodoxy and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam’s main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely guarded until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan rubbished the decree as antediluvian. The Indian Union Muslim League’s silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women’s forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot equivocate when women’s right to public participation is open to challenge. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, *Vande Mataram* and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid strained relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not confer on religious authorities the right to regulate women’s freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were awash with videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram’s remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while making exceptions for orthodoxy.

Many layers

Farmers need more storage facilities and better distribution networks

Since the 1960s, India has developed a balancing-act habit: between keeping food prices affordably low for consumers and assuring farmers of remunerative prices, with the state’s interventions focused on managing this volatility in the short term. This is also why the government banned onion exports from December 2023 to May 2024, then imposed a \$550/tonne minimum export price and a 40% export duty, reduced the duty to 20% in September 2024, and finally abolished it in April 2025. But erratic weather together with the lack of long-term relief has rendered the act increasingly awkward. From farmers’ point of view, the government often changes its mind after they have made important production-related decisions based on the expected price. On the other hand, during the bounteous *rabi* harvest, onion farmers in Maharashtra, the country’s principal supplier, had argued that the Centre’s procurement price of ₹12.35/kg would not cover the costs of cultivation. The Centre subsequently raised the price to up to ₹26.45/kg, but many farmers – including some who had had to sell at ₹1/kg earlier because of low quality and lack of storage, among other factors – were unable to capture the higher value, exposing the limits of intervening after prices have already collapsed and not reaching all farmers or grades of produce.

While the government has alluded to some price manipulation, the dominant issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking proactive measures, including improving storage options, maintaining a less erratic trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the *kharif* crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges associated with storing onions and maintaining large buffers, are simply among the pressures that highlighted the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu’s targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is commendably designed to discourage hoarding while allowing private retail prices to cool down. However, the State must also guard against the pitfalls of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network – its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more susceptible than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% – and if the need arises to persist with the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly exhausted, more so given this year’s high storage losses of around 30%.

On August 25, 2026, in Beijing, National Security Adviser Ajit Doval and China’s Foreign Minister Wang Yi held the 25th round of talks between the Special Representatives (SRs) on the India-China boundary question. That evening’s readouts from both sides were anodyne and notably avoided a phrase that has dominated this discussion for a year: early harvest. A day later, the two sides released an “Eight Points of Outcomes and Consensus”. Point 3 restored and enhanced the phrase: the Expert Group on Boundary Delimitation and the Working Group on Border Management, set up under the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC) a year ago, would “respectively advance discussions on an Early and Substantial Harvest of boundary delimitation and Border Management”. Their first task, it adds, is to agree on their own terms of reference, one year after they were constituted, suggesting that whatever is being contemplated remains at an early stage

An uncertain Early Harvest

The phrase “Early and Substantial Harvest” is significant because it is India’s own coinage. When Beijing first proposed settling the Sikkim Sector alone, India’s considered response, around 2019, was a counter-proposal on an “Early and Substantial Harvest” covering the Sikkim Sector together with the entire Middle Sector, with the boundary delineated along the watershed. China rejected the proposal. In subsequent discussions on an “Early Harvest,” China reportedly agreed only to include the Sikkim Sector and some undisputed areas of the Middle Sector – a proposal that was unacceptable to India.

The exact Indian formulation has now resurfaced in a joint document. This could mean that Beijing has accepted India’s terms – which this writer doubts – as that would involve China giving up its claim to approximately 2,450 square kilometres of territory in the Middle Sector, all south of the watershed boundary (Barahoti, Giu-Kaurik, Nilang-Jadhang, Sangcha Malla, and Lapthal). It could equally mean something the Indian side had rejected earlier: an “agreement with holes”, a settlement nominally covering both sectors but confined to stretches where the claims already coincide, leaving the trijunctions and contested pockets of the Middle Sector undefined.

If that is the case, we will have the same asymmetric outcome as with a Sikkim-only settlement – India conceding ground where its position is strong, without any progress in the Eastern and Western Sectors, where China maintains its hardline position, “dong tiao xi rang”, meaning “meaningful adjustments by India in the East and corresponding concessions by China in the West”. It would also jettison a key provision (Article III) of the 2005 Agreement on



Ashok K. Kantha

Former Ambassador of India to China; Subhas Chandra Bose Chair Professor of International Relations at Chanakya University, Bengaluru, and the lead Indian negotiator for the Agreement on Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for Boundary Settlement (2005)

India-China boundary talks suggest movement, but hard questions remain over strategic costs and concessions

Political Parameters and Guiding Principles for the Settlement of the India-China Boundary, which calls for a “package settlement ...covering all sectors of the India-China boundary”, opting instead to bank the easy gains immediately while leaving the hard issues open on China’s terms. The package clause exists precisely because the boundary’s four sectors are strategically interlinked, requiring cross-sector give and take.

No open-and-shut case

The Sikkim Sector is also not the open-and-shut case that some suggest. The two sides agree that the Anglo-Chinese Convention of 1890 is the “basis of the alignment” of the boundary in this sector. However, Article I of the Convention contains two stipulations that are mutually contradictory. Its first sentence makes the watershed crest the boundary, while its second names Mount Gipmochi as the starting point on the Bhutan frontier. Yet, British Indian maps of 1907 and 1913 placed the trijunction not at Gipmochi but roughly 6.5 kilometres to its north, on the true watershed crest. India and Bhutan read the watershed principle as controlling and place the trijunction at Batang La; China seizes on the literal reference to Gipmochi to push the trijunction southwards, onto the Jampheri Ridge. A Sikkim delimitation built on the 1890 text, unless it repudiates Gipmochi, would be read by Beijing as conceding the southern trijunction.

Even a trijunction-reserved settlement would strip India of the standing to counsel Bhutan against a bilateral deal, having itself settled out of turn nearby. China’s “package proposal” to Bhutan – relinquishing roughly 495 sq km of claims in the north in exchange for Bhutan ceding about 269 sq km in the northwest, including the Doklam Plateau – would gain fresh momentum, deepening China’s presence in the Chumbi Valley and opening a path to the Jampheri Ridge, from which the entire Siliguri Corridor, India’s sole overland link to its northeastern States, would come under direct observation. This is not hypothetical: since the 2017 Doklam standoff, China has spent years building roads, villages, and military facilities across western Bhutan, gaining de facto control over Doklam.

A genuine “Early and Substantial Harvest” requires three things. First, delineation must proceed on the highest-watershed principle across the entire stretch in both sectors, rather than selectively along segments where the two positions already converge, which would serve no purpose for India. Second, trijunction points, at Batang La and any comparable third-country-adjacent points in the Middle Sector, must be explicitly excluded from the Expert Group’s mandate and settled only in consultation with the country concerned, as stipulated in the 2012 Common Understanding between the two SRs. However, unless the highest-watershed principle is accepted, silence

Reducing India’s exposure to U.S. tariff risks



Himanshu Jaiswal

Consultant at the Centre for Social and Economic Progress, New Delhi

The Lindsey O. Graham Act puts India under pressure, but export diversification and domestic reforms can cushion shocks

the strategy has helped secure supplies, it carries diplomatic costs, particularly in managing ties with the United States, which seeks to strongly discourage these imports. The U.S. Russia Sanctions Act reflects this pressure.

On July 24, before the bill’s introduction, the U.S. imposed forced-labour tariffs on 60 countries, including India, under Section 301 of the Trade Act of 1974, imposing an additional 10% tariff, a replacement of the expired 10% duty under Section 122, on India. If the Russia Sanctions Act becomes law, India’s cumulative tariff could reach 110%, making it one of the most heavily tariffed countries. Such high tariffs could affect India’s price competitiveness in the U.S., a major export market, leading to economic losses. China’s cumulative tariff could reach 112.5%, as both countries are major importers of Russian crude.

Trade simulations and results

To analyse the trade dynamics and possible way forward for India, two global trade simulations were conducted using the GTAP dataset and model, a global general equilibrium model that captures global linkages and country-level shocks. The first (sanction scenario) models a 110% U.S. tariff on India, with other countries facing forced-labour tariffs and China facing 112.5%. The second (diversification scenario) applies the same tariffs while India pursues export diversification, proxied by a full India-European Union free trade agreement (FTA).

The simulation results suggest that the proposed U.S. sanctions could have adverse consequences for the Indian economy. Under the sanction scenario, India’s welfare declines by nearly \$47 billion, while GDP, output, domestic demand, exports, and imports all contract. Aggregate exports fall by 5.1% and imports by 5.2%, reflecting disrupted trade flows and weaker

on the trijunction will, on the ground, be filled in Beijing’s favour in Bhutan. Third, the terms of reference for the Expert Group must extend India’s 2019 proposal in good faith, rather than dilute it beyond recognition.

Several questions about these negotiations remain unanswered. The Chinese readout of August 25 reiterates a commitment to a “package” settlement, but how will that commitment be reconciled with a piecemeal approach to settlement? How is the setting up of an Expert Group on Delimitation consistent with the instructions given to the SRs in Article X of the 2005 Agreement, which require them to “continue consultations in an earnest manner with the objective of arriving at an agreed framework for a boundary settlement, which will provide the basis for the delineation and demarcation of the India-China boundary to be subsequently undertaken by civil and military officials and surveyors of the two sides”? There is no agreed framework yet, but it is proposed to commence the process of “delimitation”, a term that the Chinese use interchangeably with “demarcation”. Indeed, the 2005 Agreement does not use the term “delimitation” at all. Will the SRs earnestly pursue negotiations on the “agreed framework”, or will they, in effect, leave it in abeyance while officials grapple with a partial delimitation exercise without such a framework? The other elements of the Eight Points – additional meeting points and hotlines for the General Level Mechanisms in the Eastern and Middle Sectors, continued pilgrimage and border trade, and a September meeting on trans-border rivers – are useful, incremental confidence-building measures. But they belong to a different track from boundary settlement and should not be conflated in public discussion.

The Eight Points are silent on the Medog County project on the Yarlung Tsangpo River, while referring to both sides agreeing to “maintain communication on (trans-border river) issues, including hydrological data sharing and renewal of the relevant MoUs”, without reporting any progress. The September meeting should convey India’s concerns about the project – the world’s largest hydropower plant – being built close to the border in the Eastern Sector, in a highly earthquake-prone zone, a risk underscored by the flash floods in Nepal on August 26.

Avoid optics

Two points bear reiteration. First, the 2005 agreement – the only substantive outcome of 23 years of SR talks – must not be diluted; China has sought to reinterpret and undermine it since its conclusion. Second, Indian negotiators must guard against the temptation to project contrived progress. Diplomacy that trades long-term strategic interests for short-term optics is self-defeating.

economic activity. The results indicate that a prolonged tariff-based confrontation with the U.S. could impose substantial costs on India’s growth and trade performance.

The picture changes considerably when India responds through export diversification. With a functional India-EU FTA, the economy turns around despite the same tariff environment. Welfare improves by \$26.3 billion, GDP turns positive, and sectoral output and domestic demand recover by around 1%. Aggregate exports increase by 3.1%, while imports rise by a moderate 2.6%, indicating stronger production and trade integration with alternative markets.

The findings suggest that even if India continues procuring crude from Russia to strengthen its energy security, the adverse economic effects of U.S. tariffs can be mitigated to a large extent through export diversification. The India-EU FTA, used here as a proxy for diversification, demonstrates that India must increasingly look beyond the U.S. and expand its presence in alternative markets, even as the U.S. remains one of its largest export destinations.

The strategy to pursue

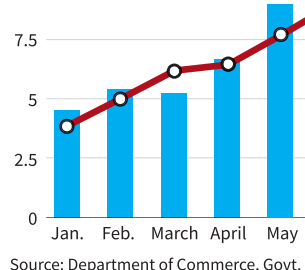
However, diversification is not a panacea. It depends on the ability of other markets to absorb additional Indian exports. Without adequate external demand, diversification may remain limited.

Therefore, export diversification must be complemented by sustained domestic reforms, including trade facilitation, removal of non-tariff barriers, improved logistics and standards, and movement up the goods quality ladder. Such a strategy would not only enhance India’s resilience to future geopolitical shocks but also strengthen its long-term export competitiveness.

The views expressed are personal

India’s crude import from Russia

Quantity (MMT)
Share in total crude imports (%)



Source: Department of Commerce, Govt. of India

Impact of tariffs and export diversification

	Sanction scenario	Diversification scenario
Welfare (\$ billion)	-46.6	26.3
Change in GDP (%)	-0.02	0.01
Sectoral output (%)	-1.9	1.2
Domestic demand (%)	-1.8	1
Aggregate export (%)	-5.1	3.1
Aggregate import (%)	-5.2	2.6

Source: Writer’s analysis using GTAP

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The north-south lens

The main article (Editorial page, September 2) risks turning a complex federal question into a simplistic north-versus-south narrative. India’s political influence has never been determined by geography alone; it reflects population, electoral mandates, governance, economic contribution and the ability of States to build national

coalitions. The southern States continue to exercise considerable political, economic and institutional influence, while several leaders from the region have shaped national policy. Portraying elected southern governments as “suppliant” or “submissive” is subjective and needlessly polarising. Delimitation deserves rigorous constitutional

debate, but framing it primarily as northern domination may deepen regional divisions rather than strengthen India’s federal compact.

Venkat Parthasarathy,
Hyderabad

Austerity call

The call to citizens of the country to avoid unnecessary foreign travel and destination weddings

abroad to conserve foreign exchange would carry greater weight if accompanied by restraint from those at the top. Overseas travel by national leaders may often be necessary in the public interest, but when citizens are asked to limit their foreign expenditure, similar prudence from those in positions of authority would strengthen the message.

Leadership is not only about asking citizens to sacrifice, but also about setting an example.

Tharcus S. Fernando,
Chennai

Football’s great artist

Legend Lionel Messi’s retirement from international football marks the end of one of modern sport’s most extraordinary chapters. For two decades,

he transformed football into an art form, carrying Argentina’s expectations through years of heartbreak and criticism. He leaves the international stage not only as a statistical giant, but also as a symbol of humility, grace and vision.

R. Sivakumar,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

River-linking is not the solution

The Union Minister for Home Affairs Amit Shah's speech at the Southern Zonal Council's meeting last month in Mamallapuram has provided a few takeaways on the contentious issue of water sharing. His emphasis on the need for an early resolution of water-related issues in the southern region appears well meaning but it is easier said than done. He had also talked about linking major rivers from the Brahmaputra to the Godavari and the Cauvery, an option that, according to Mr. Shah, can ensure that India faces no water shortage for 100 years.

However, water issues are not that easy to solve. This is evident from the Centre's response to Tamil Nadu's demand for the constitution of a tribunal to adjudicate the Pennaiyar river water dispute. Aggrieved over the "violation" of the 1892 inter-State agreement by Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, in November 2019, requested the Centre to establish a tribunal. It had also moved the Supreme Court with the same demand. Since then, two negotiation committees have been formed and 11 meetings held. Eventually, the top court, this February, directed the Centre to form the tribunal within a month and, later, extended the deadline by six months.

Still, the adjudicatory body is yet to be put in place. Meanwhile, the Centre asked the court whether the Pennaiyar dispute could be referred to the Mahadayi Water Dispute Tribunal instead of constituting a new tribunal. This suggestion defies logic as there is nothing in common between the two



T. Ramakrishnan

disputes. Moreover, the Interstate River Water Disputes Act, 1956 does not permit it. This suggestion in the Pennaiyar case gives the impression that the Centre is not keen on expeditiously implementing a judicial verdict in an inter-State river dispute. To cite one more example, the Central government has not yet replied to Tamil Nadu's demand, in March this year, to constitute a tribunal on the Mekedatu dam project proposed by Karnataka.

A complex problem
Given this background, one need not delve much into the complications that would entail by the inter-linking of rivers. Proponents of river linking, including Tamil Nadu, have been saying that the idea is not to disturb the natural flow of any river but to divert a portion of the surplus water. Many experts are not convinced about this argument as they are worried that once the linking is allowed, regions that benefit may become vociferous in demanding water even in times of distress, eventually depriving original beneficiaries of their quota. This is apart from the concerns over the possible adverse consequences on ecology. In fact, Keralam has been stoutly opposing the Pamba-Achankovil-Vaippar link proposal, which, if implemented, the State says, will affect the Vembanad wetland system, where the Pamba and Achankovil rivers drain. However, the National Water Development Agency says that it has accounted for improving the flow of rivers in lean periods.

In the last 130-odd years, the country has seen only a handful of inter-basin transfer projects, most of which are in south India

In the last 130-odd years, the country has seen only a handful of inter-basin transfer projects, most of which are in south India

Mullaperiyar dam, the Parambikulam-Aliyar project, the Krishna Water Supply Project, and the Indira Gandhi Canal Project are regarded as successful examples of inter-basin transfer of river waters. After the Bharatiya Janata Party's return to power in 2014, the Union government formed a Special Committee for Interlinking of Rivers, which has held over two dozen meetings since then. Needless to say, there has not been much headway.

However, in 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for the ₹44,000 crore Ken-Betwa Link Project. This has now led to agitations by the tribal populations in Chhatarpur.

What the governments, both at the Centre and in States, and civil society should focus on is demand side management, instead of perpetually looking for supply side interventions. With land becoming scarcely available and resistance growing among people when it comes to land acquisition, the days of implementing mega irrigation projects are almost over. The priority has to be towards conserving what is available and using it judiciously. A massive programme of sensitising and incentivising farmers on the optimal use of water has to be launched. Indiscriminate extraction of groundwater, facilitated by schemes of free electricity for agriculture in many States, is paving the way for ecological disaster and has to be curbed immediately. Unless water conservation becomes the mantra of all the stakeholders and is practised genuinely, disputes will be the norm.

ramakrishnan.t@thehindu.co.in

Mental health must anchor public health

India stands at a defining moment in its journey towards the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047. Under the Healthcare for All pillar, the government has rightly prioritised strengthening Ayushman Bharat, expanding primary healthcare, reducing out-of-pocket expenditure, and promoting preventive care. Yet there is one element that cuts across all these ambitions and determines their success: mental health.

Mental health is not a niche concern. It influences educational attainment, workforce participation, social cohesion, and physical health outcomes. A healthier and more productive India cannot be built without placing mental well-being at the centre of public health.

Major implications
The scale of the challenge is substantial. Mental illness affects one in seven Indians, with nearly 200 million people living with a diagnosable mental health condition. The contribution of mental disorders to India's total disease burden has doubled over the past three decades. Yet the national treatment gap remains 84.5%, meaning that more than four out of five people who need care do not receive it. The reasons are well known. India has only 0.3 psychiatrists per 1,00,000 population, alongside significant shortages in clinical psychologists, psychiatric social workers, and psychiatric nurses. These shortages are the result of decades during which mental health received insufficient attention, both in India and globally.

Mental disorders significantly increase the risk



Indu Bhushan

Founding CEO of India's National Health Authority and Ayushman Bharat



Anisha Padukone

CEO of The Live Love Laugh Foundation

of chronic diseases, while chronic diseases in turn increase the risk of mental illness. More than 60% of people attending primary care facilities have a diagnosable mental disorder. Rates of anxiety and depression are substantially higher among people living with diabetes, hypertension, tuberculosis, and HIV/AIDS. Ignoring mental health, therefore, undermines efforts to control non-communicable diseases and reduce healthcare expenditure.

The economic implications are equally compelling. A 2025 modelling study by researchers from PGIMER and NIMHANS estimated that integrating universal depression screening into India's primary healthcare system could generate net savings of ₹291 billion to ₹482 billion annually, equivalent to as much as 0.32% of GDP. Mental health is not a social welfare issue alone – it is also a human capital investment and an economic growth strategy.

The encouraging news is that India has already built many of the foundations required for transformation. More than 1.73 lakh sub-centres and primary health centres have been converted into Ayushman Bharat Arogya Mandirs, with mental healthcare included among the essential service packages. The District Mental Health Programme now covers more than 90% of districts. Tele-MANAS, launched in 2022, has expanded across all States and Union Territories.

Three main priorities
The task now is not to start from scratch. It is to build on this foundation at scale. First, one must empower

If India is to become a truly developed nation by 2047, mental health must move from the margins of public policy to its centre

Decoding Russia's reliance on Indian petroleum products

Ukraine's recent relentless attacks on Russia's oil refineries has led the country to rely on India for petroleum imports

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis

Recent Ukrainian attacks on Russia's oil refineries has resulted in the latter importing refined petroleum products from India in significant quantities for the first time, at least since the Russia-Ukraine war started in February 2022.

As per multiple media reports, including one by the *Press Trust of India*, Indian refiners sent about one million barrels over the last two months, alongside Turkey and Morocco. Russia's import of petroleum products from India has remained negligible in the past, accounting for less than one per cent of India's petroleum exports. The bulk of exports went to countries like the Netherlands, Australia and the UAE (**Chart 1**).

Though the Indian government's export and import-related data for the last two months is yet to be released, reports have confirmed that the country's export of refined petroleum products to Russia has sharply increased in the last two months. This has tilted the huge imbalance that existed between the two countries in oil trade, albeit marginally. India continues to remain hugely dependent on Russia for crude.

One-fourth of India's petroleum imports since January 2022 were from Russia and this number remained high before U.S. President Donald Trump imposed additional tariffs on India in October 2025 for buying crude from Russia.

Though this resulted in India sharply cutting down its crude import from Russia, the imports resumed in full swing soon after. In fact, after the U.S. and Israel launched a war with Iran in February this year, the former did a U-turn in its stance and tacitly encouraged Russian crude supplies into the market to negate the impact of Iran's blockade in the Strait of Hormuz.

Chart 2 shows how Russia accounted for nearly one-third (31.6%) of India's crude imports as of June 2026. India imported \$531 million worth of crude from Russia in June 2026, which is roughly double that of its import from the country in January 2022, a month before Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

Amid Ukraine's continued targeting of Russia's oil refining infrastructure, the Russian Federation's Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak said in July that the country would begin importing oil products to help stabilise the domestic market.

Consistent attacks

According to the International Strategic Action Network for Security, there were at least 17 attacks on 16 different oil refineries in Russia. Eight attacks were targeted at oil depots and oil pumping stations in July (**Chart 3**). Though reliable data on similar attacks in August are not available yet, they seem to have continued at the same rate, resulting in petrol and diesel shortages.

Data from the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) show that Russia's refinery crude throughput went from about 5.18 million barrels per day in Q12026 (January to March) in the beginning of the year, to about 3.88 million barrels per day in Q32026. The attacks also seem to have contributed to a surge in crude exports from Russia, as unplanned refinery outages diverted higher volumes of crude to the export market. India, which ranks fourth in oil-refining capacity in the world, has utilised Russia's sudden demand to export refined petroleum products, mainly from private refineries (**Chart 4**). Considering the time it would take for Russia to bring its refining capacity back to its earlier capacity, the surge in exports could continue, which will help India in easing its pressure on foreign exchange in the coming months.



The data were sourced from India's Ministry of Commerce and Industry, the International Strategic Action Network for Security, the Statistical Review of World Energy BP, and the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries. With inputs from Gandla Sneha, who is interning with The Hindu Data Team

CHART 1: Russia's share in India's petroleum exports has traditionally been less than 1% (not visible in the chart)

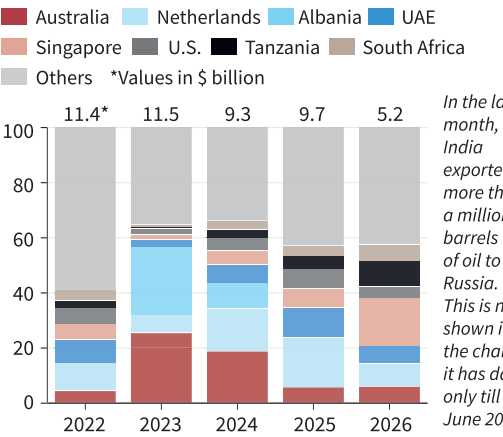


CHART 2: Russia accounted for more than one-fourth of India's total crude imports since January 2022

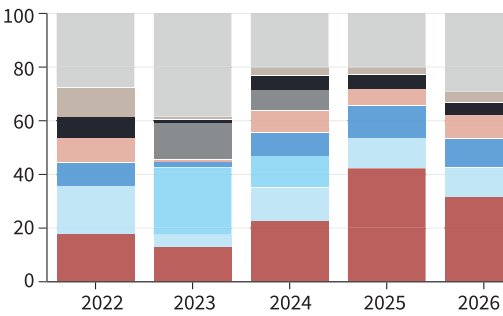


CHART 3: A total of 17 attacks were recorded against 16 different oil refineries in Russia in July

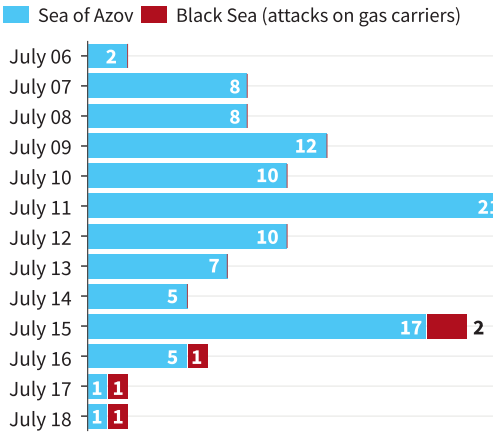
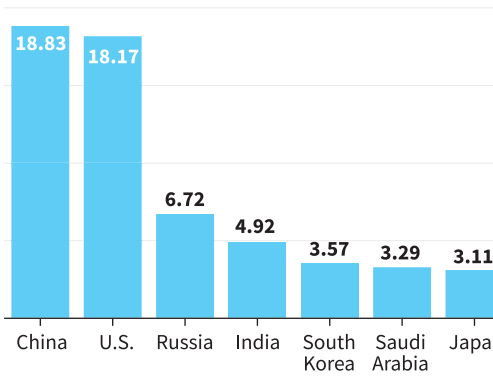


CHART 4: The seven countries with the highest oil refining capacity in the world. Values in million barrels per day



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The *Hindu*.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 3, 1976

Tip-off leads to underground vault

Madras, September 2: Sixteen exquisite bronze idols and 17 puja utensils all valued at Rs. one crore have been recovered from an underground vault in the ancient Kalyanasundarar Temple in Nallur, Papanasam taluk in Thanjavur district. The temple is under the control of the Tiruvaduthurai Adheenam.

Officials of the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Department and State Directorate of Archaeology, led by Dr. R. Nagaswami, Director of Archaeology, acting on a hint thrown by the temple executive searched and found the vault. A representative of the Tiruvaduthurai Adheenam was present during the search. The Math's records indicate that these valuable images and jewels had been deposited in the safe vault in 1942.

These rare pieces of art were retrieved earlier this week after securing an order from the State Government to rummage the underground cell in the temple precincts.

Apart from the discovery of the valuable pieces from the subterranean chamber, this probe has given a clue to the traditional method of safeguarding precious idols and ornaments of a temple and the care bestowed on preservation of art forms.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 3, 1926

Slavery in Burma frontier

Rangoon, September 2: *The Rangoon Gazette* says that the successful emancipation of slaves in Hukawng valley last season will, it is said, be followed this cold season by an expedition to that part of unadministered territory between Malikha and Nmaikha rivers, north of their junction to the Irrawaddy river and locally known as the triangle where the same system of slavery as existed in Hukawng valley still prevails. The triangles though not as extensive a territory as Hukawng valley, is more densely populated and the number of slaves to be liberated will be more numerous. It is expected that Mr. J.T.O. Barnard, Deputy Commissioner, Burma, Frontier Service, who was principally responsible for the arrangements for the emancipation of the slaves in the Hukawng valley will be placed on this duty and in charge of the expedition. *The Gazette's* statement is yet unconfirmed.

CBI should probe ‘cash for transfer scam’ in Punjab: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday demanded the resignation of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the “cash for transfer” charges in the State.

There were serious allegations of institutional corruption in Punjab, BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said. Citing the purported findings of a probe by the Enforcement Directorate (ED), he alleged that money was being taken for the transfers and postings of senior bureaucrats and police officers.

Confidential government documents had reached middlemen, but despite seven letters from the ED, no FIR had been registered, the BJP leader said. He demanded the immediate resignation of Mr. Mann and a fair investigation by the CBI.

Claiming that Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal and Mr. Mann “have today become symbols of corruption”, Mr. Bhatia alleged that senior Punjab officials were involved in the “scam”. “Their transfers



Gaurav Bhatia

and postings are carried out according to a rate card... This rate card fixes the price for who will get which charge and in which department they will be posted,” he said.

The facts presented by the ED before the Punjab and Haryana High Court in its affidavit revealed that confidential documents, draft lists of postings and transfers, and draft lists of government policies to be implemented in the future were found on WhatsApp on the mobile phones of alleged middlemen and touts, Mr. Bhatia said.

“The concerning aspect is that... the ED told the Punjab Police that this was a cognisable offence and that an FIR should be registered. However, despite seven letters being written to the Punjab Police, no FIR was registered,” he said.

Air Force veteran appointed first Ram Temple Trust CEO

Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) served in IAF for 31 years; Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey, Nirmala Yadav named trustees; move comes amid allegation of donation theft

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on Wednesday appointed Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) as its first chief executive officer.

The appointment came at a time when the Trust is strengthening its administrative structure amid allegations of theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

The appointment was announced after a meeting of the Trust at the Maniram Das Chawani in Ayodhya, where the trustees also filled three vacant positions on the Board.

The vacancies arose following the resignations of senior Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader and general secretary Champat Rai, and trustee Anil Mishra. They quit in July after the embezzlement allegations surfaced.

The third vacancy arose after the death of trustee Vimlendra Pratap Mishra, a member of Ayodhya's erstwhile royal family.

According to a commu-



Air Vice-Marshal Jitendra Mishra (ret'd) was awarded the Sarvottam Yudh Seva Medal and was also a part of Operation Sindoor. PTI

nique issued by the Trust, Air Vice-Marshal Mishra was appointed following the recommendations of a committee constituted to select the CEO.

The process involved scrutinising about 5,585 applications, and interviewing hundreds of candidates over a period of nearly two months.

Air Vice-Marshal Mishra served in the Indian Air Force for 31 years, holding positions across different departments and gaining extensive leadership experience, the Trust said.

It added that the new CEO was also awarded the Sarvottam Yudh Seva Me-

dal, one of the highest military decorations for distinguished service in wartime. He was also part of Operation Sindoor.

‘Unaware of selection’

He had not been aware of his selection prior to the announcement made to the media on Wednesday, Air Vice-Marshal Mishra told *The Hindu*.

“I also got to know about my selection through television. I am elated,” he said.

The trustees also appointed three new members – Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey, and Nirmala Yadav – to fill

the vacant positions. Mr. Bhagchandka is associated with Ashok Singhla Foundation, while Mr. Pandey is an advocate.

Ms. Yadav will be the first woman to hold a trusteeship in the Trust.

Swami Govind Dev Giri will continue as the Trust's general secretary, while Mr. Bhagchandka will take charge as treasurer. The Trust's annual accounts for 2025-26 have also been approved.

Financial details

The Trust recorded a total income of about ₹237 crore, and expenditure of about ₹99 crore during the financial year. It also incurred about ₹425 crore in capital expenditure on construction and related works. As of March 31, the Trust had total funds of about ₹1,882 crore.

The VHP hailed the appointment of the CEO. VHP president Alok Kumar described Air Vice-Marshal Mishra as a senior and respected personality, adding that his extensive experience would help the Trust function more effectively and transparently.

Cong. cites Garg's analysis to question GDP growth figures

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government under Modi between 2017 and 2019

PAWAN KHERA
Congress leader

The Congress on Wednesday stepped up its attack on the Union government over the latest GDP figures, citing reported remarks by former Finance Secretary Subhash Chandra Garg to argue that the Centre was using statistical revisions to present an inflated picture of economic growth.

Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh shared a video clip of Mr. Garg, who said that revisions to the previous year's GDP had affected comparisons with the current year's figures.

According to Mr. Garg, without the revision, growth at current prices in the April-June quarter would have been around 2.6%, instead of the higher figure being projected.

Mr. Ramesh said the government's claims of robust economic growth, amplified through what he described as statistical “jugglery”, were at odds with conditions on the ground.

‘Burst the bubble’

“Former Finance Secretary Subhash Garg has now burst the bubble on this claim. His assessment is that the real GDP growth is around 2.6%, not 7.8%,” Mr. Ramesh said in a post on social media platform X. “The Modi government must understand: PR can polish the picture of GDP, but not the economy itself,” he said.

The Congress leader said the government needed to acknowledge the actual state of the economy and undertake reforms to

generate employment, strengthen MSMEs and private investment, raise demand and incomes, reduce inequality and ensure fair competition instead of promoting “crony capitalists”.

Mr. Ramesh said it was significant that questions were being raised over the GDP figures by a former Finance Secretary who had served in the Modi government.

Congress media and publicity department chairman Pawan Khera said Mr. Garg's assessment appeared closer to the “lived reality” of ordinary Indians, marked by rising prices, weakening purchasing power, shrinking disposable incomes and savings, stagnant employment opportunities and increasing household debt.

Seeks explanation

“These claims cannot simply be dismissed. They come from someone who served as Finance and Economic Affairs Secretary of the Government of India under Modi between 2017 and 2019,” Mr. Khera said, demanding an explanation for the revision of the previous year's GDP figures.

Provide security to rural communities before a crisis strikes, says Cong. chief

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Wednesday said rural communities should not be remembered only during droughts, floods, crop failures or elections, and called for a development model that provides them security before a crisis strikes.

He was speaking at an event organised by the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Foundation and the Dr. KVP Foundation, where the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF) was conferred the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award, 2026.

Mr. Kharge said governments must ensure that farmers have fair markets, rural families have decent livelihoods, and women have economic indepen-



Big honour: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge with Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy in New Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

dence, while tribal communities and villages need access to technology, opportunities and basic infrastructure. “The government has an important role in creating this security, so that the communities become partners in India's development,” he said.

The Congress president also took a swipe at the

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh. Without naming anyone, he said he had heard an RSS leader claim that India had witnessed many reforms. Mr. Kharge said it was the Congress that had carried out the reforms being referred to.

Linking the award to the legacies of Rajasekhara Reddy and agricultural

scientist M.S. Swaminathan, Mr. Kharge said both believed that development must ultimately serve the dignity of ordinary people.

Rajasekhara Reddy, he said, had worked for the poor and marginalised, while Swaminathan had sought to combine scientific advancement with social equity and environmental sustainability.

Paying tribute to Swaminathan, Mr. Kharge recalled his contribution to the Green Revolution and recalled how the late scientists had described Indira Gandhi as the “most successful warrior against hunger”.

In a video message, Soumya Swaminathan, chair of the MSSRF and daughter of M.S. Swaminathan thanked the organisers for conferring the award on the foundation.

Kapil Sibal seeks SC intervention over ‘bulk SIR deletions’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal on Wednesday urged the Supreme Court to stop the “bulk deletions” taking place under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Mr. Sibal alleged that the ongoing SIR was aimed at helping the BJP win elections. In a post on X, he termed it “politics of exclusion”, and alleged that “BJP agents” were looking to “target Muslims, seek bulk deletions”. He added, “Supreme Court needs to stop this!”

Addressing a press conference here, Mr. Sibal cited a report from Jharkhand, alleging that the form to request the deletion of names from the voters' list was being filed in bulk by BJP workers.

“You can file bulk forms – you can take 45 of them,

or 100 of them, or even 400 of them. You can file the forms, and you can say that this name should be deleted. You don't have to give any reason for it, and if it is found to be false, it doesn't matter,” he said.

Earlier, *The Hindu* had reported that cases of Form 7 being submitted in bulk had surfaced in States like Rajasthan, Gujarat and Assam.

‘Serious issue’

Mr. Sibal alleged that many people whose names were sought to be deleted were Muslims and had been living in their area for years.

“Therefore, this is a very serious issue, and if courts don't take care of this issue, if courts just believe that the SIR exercise is by a neutral EC, then I think we are in deep trouble; this democracy will be in deep trouble,” the Rajya Sabha member said.

Former AIMIM leader joins Congress ahead of 2027 U.P. election

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Syed Asim Waqar, former spokesperson of the All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM), joined the Congress on Wednesday, alleging that the Asaduddin Owaisi-led party paid lip service to the objective of defeating the Bharatiya Janata Party while fighting the Opposition parties on the ground.

Mr. Waqar joined the Congress at the party headquarters here in the presence of All India Congress Committee (AICC) in-charge for Uttar Pradesh Rajendra Pal Gautam, State Congress president Ajay Rai and AICC Minority Department chairman Imran Pratapgarhi.

Explaining his decision, Mr. Waqar said his years in the AIMIM had convinced him that a party seeking to remove the BJP from pow-



Syed Asim Waqar

er could not simultaneously weaken those fighting the ruling party. “If we keep fighting the Opposition and do not allow it to grow, then we are helping the BJP,” Mr. Waqar said.

Mr. Rai said Mr. Waqar's induction would strengthen the party in Uttar Pradesh ahead of the 2027 Assembly election. A key AIMIM voice in Uttar Pradesh and considered close to Mr. Owaisi, Mr. Waqar's exit comes as the AIMIM seeks to expand its political footprint in the State.

Rahul takes stock of Maharashtra issues

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday sought a detailed assessment of key political issues in Maharashtra, including the deletion of names from the electoral rolls, Maratha and OBC reservation issues and tribal protests.

He is in Nashik for the

party's *Sanghatan Srujan Abhiyan*.

Later, Mr. Gandhi interacted with the families of the district Congress committee presidents before addressing the concluding session of the training camp. He urged the district presidents to expand the organisation and take the Congress's ideology to people across the State.

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2662/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001567) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Establishment of 220/33kV Murmi (Dahegaon Bangla) S/S along with construction of LILo on existing 220kV Waluj Chitegaon SC line (RL-12.99km) at 220kV Murmi Substation, Tal. Gangapur, Dist. Ch. Sambhajinagar under Ch. Sambhajinagar Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **31.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

**BENGALURU CENTRAL CITY CORPORATION**
Office of the Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, Thimmaiah Road, Queens Road, Bangalore

Tender NO. EE/SJN/E-PROC/27/2026-27
Date: 02.09.2026

**INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER
(TWO COVER SYSTEM)**
(Through GOK KPP Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> only)
The Executive Engineer (Shivaji Nagar Division), BCCC, Bangalore invites tenders from eligible Contractors registered in CPWD / KPWD / Railways /MES/ National Highway or any State Government Organizations for the construction of work detailed in the table below.
Standard Tender Document KW4.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1.	Heritage restoration, Reconstruction & development of Russel Market in Shivajinagara in Bengaluru City Amount Put to Tender : Rs.7,000.00 Lakhs. EMD : Rs.70,00,000.00.

Calendar of Events : (1) Tenders must be submitted online through e-procurement portal on or before **16.00 hours on 03.10.2026** and the opening of tenders will be as per the e-procurement portal guidelines. (2) Pre bid meeting will be held on **24.09.2026 at 15.00** in the office of the Chief Engineer Zone-2, Bengaluru City Central Palike, Annexure-3, 4th Floor, GBA office compound, N R Square, Bengaluru (3) Last Date for uploading the Filled Tender Document is **03.10.2026 upto 16.00pm**. (4) Date of Technical bid opening of Tenders is on **05.10.2026 by 11.00 am** (5) Date of Financial bid Opening of Tenders is on after Technical bid approved.
Sd/- Executive Engineer, Shivaji Nagar Division, BCCC

**Maharashtra State Agricultural Marketing Board,Pune (MSAMB)**

E-Tender Notice

MSAMB invites e-Tender for Construction of a Modern Primary Processing Center for Orange at Agricultural Produce Market Committee, Katol (Sub Market Khangoan), Taluka - Katol, Dist.Nagpur. Estimated cost of said work is Rs.625.23 Lakhs (GST extra). For details, please visit www.msamb.com and <https://mahatenders.gov.in>.
Managing Director

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2671/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001585) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Establishment of 110/22kV Gaikwadpada GIS substation, Dist. Thane with associated lines using 220kV equipments and UG cable on turnkey basis under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. खण्ड घाटोल
जिला बांसवाड़ा (राज.)
क्रमांक :- 515
दिनांक :- 18/08/2026

निविदा संशोधन
निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27
NIB CODE:- PWD262742362

इस खण्ड कार्यालय के पत्रांक 499 दिनांक 14.08.2026 द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा सूचना संख्या 07/2026-27 में दलित कार्य संख्या 1 एवं 4 में विधिल कार्य हेतु अनुमानित लागत राशि एवं बरोहर राशि में विन्मनुसार संशोधन किया जाता है :-

कार्य क्रम संख्या	पूर्व निर्धारित अनुमानित लागत (लाखों में)	पूर्व निर्धारित बरोहर राशि (लाखों में)	संशोधित अनुमानित लागत (लाखों में)	संशोधित बरोहर राशि (लाखों में)
1	42.50	8500	42.52	8504
2	32.66	65320	38.54	77080

नोट- निविदा की शेष राशि मूल निविदा सूचना अनुसार रहेगी।
(सोपान विवरण)
अधिशाषी अभियन्ता सा.नि.वि. खंड घाटोल
DI/PC/15544/2026

**MAHATRANSKO**
Maharashtra State Electricity Transmission Co. Ltd.

**INVITATION FOR BID (IFB)
(LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING)**

SRM e-Tender No. T-2681/MSETCL/CO/Projects/Pre-Tender (RFx No. 6000001579) (2nd Call)
MSETCL invites offers by SRM e-tendering in TWO bid system (Techno-Commercial Bid and Price Bid) from the eligible registered bidders for the following work as detailed below.
“Work of (A) Establishment of 400/220kV Kalwa GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines & (B) Establishment of 400/220kV Padghe Split GIS Substation along with reorientation of 400kV and 220kV lines under Vashi Zone, MSETCL, Maharashtra.”
Interested bidders may obtain further information available on the website. <https://srmetender.mahatransco.in>
The date of downloading of Bid documents available on the website is from **27.08.2026**.
**Sd/-
Chief Engineer (Projects), MSETCL**

A BG-BGE

INBRIEF



Jalna Collector urges activist to withdraw hunger strike

Following a drop in his blood sugar level, Jalna Collector Ashima Mittal appealed to Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange-Patil to end his indefinite hunger strike, which entered the fifth day on Wednesday. Meanwhile, activists from the Maratha community staged *rasta roko* (road blockade) protests in Dharashiv, Beed, Jalna, and Solapur districts of Maharashtra, demanding a resolution to their demands in the quota issue. The two-hour protest disrupted traffic in many areas. Mr. Jarange-Patil refused to withdraw the his protest, and asserted that the demands raised by the protesters involved State government-level decisions.

CBI hosts India-Thailand meet on 'Live Animal Trafficking'

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has organised a two-day case coordination meeting between India and Thailand on 'Live Animal Trafficking' which commenced on Wednesday. The CBI is co-hosting the meeting in coordination with the Interpol Environmental Security Sub-Directorate (ENS). "The smuggling of exotic live animals and birds for pet trade is a growing trend in Asia. Mainly using air routes, live animals are being trafficked from Thailand, Malaysia, and Indonesia to South Asian countries, including India; Singapore is used as a transit point," said the agency.

SC seeks govt. explanation on IPS deputation in CAPFs

Justice Ujjal Bhuyan says cadre officers of CAPFs are 'completely stifled'; Home Ministry says it has taken steps to implement Supreme Court's directions and initiated cadre reviews across CAPFs

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday sought an explanation from Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan on the implementation of its May 2025 judgment directing the Centre to progressively reduce the deputation of Indian Police Service (IPS) officers to senior posts in the Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs).

While hearing the contempt petition filed by retired CAPF officers, Justice Ujjal Bhuyan orally observed that there was a "strong lobby" and the cadre officers of CAPFs were "completely stifled".

"Do you think there are no competent officers in CAPFs to hold responsible positions? This is totally wrong. There are officers who have served over 25 years in service, they are defending the borders, they are also fighting for us, supreme sacrifices they have made. There is a strong lobby there... cadre officers are completely stifled," he said.



Members of the All Ex-Paramilitary Forces Welfare Association stage a protest against the CAPF Bill in March. FILE PHOTO

On May 23, 2025, a Bench of Justice A.S. Oka and Justice Bhuyan had ruled that the deputation posts of IPS officers in the Senior Administrative Grade (SAG) or up to the rank of Inspector-General in CAPFs should be "progressively reduced over a period of time, say within an outer limit of two years." Justice Oka has since retired.

In an affidavit, Mr. Mohan informed the Supreme Court that 46 IPS officers have been brought on deputation to the CAPFs up to the SAG level after the court's 2025 judgment. The Union Home Minis-

try said it had taken a series of steps to implement the Supreme Court's directions, including initiating cadre reviews across all CAPFs, examining the issue of IPS deputation, and undertaking statutory changes. The Ministry noted that following the dismissal of its review petition on October 28, 2025, all CAPFs were directed to submit detailed cadre review proposals, which have since been examined by the Ministry and forwarded to the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) with the approval of the Home Minister.

The DoPT told the court

that cadre review proposals for the CRPF, BSF, CISF, ITBP and SSB were sent by the Ministry between July 27 and August 3, 2026. The proposals were examined in accordance with the government's cadre review guidelines and forwarded to the Department of Expenditure (DoE), along with DoPT's observations and recommendations on August 17. The DoPT said that after comments are received from the DoE, the proposals will be placed before the Cadre Review Committee headed by the Cabinet Secretary, whose recommendations would subsequently be considered for approval by the competent authority.

The next date of the hearing is September 22.

To circumvent the 2025 judgment, the government enacted the CAPFs (General Administration) Act, 2026, which was published in the Gazette on April 9. However, five writ petitions challenging the legislation have since been filed and are scheduled for hearing before the court on November 18.

HC dismisses plea challenging Rahul Gandhi's citizenship

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI



Rahul Gandhi

The Lucknow Bench of the Allahabad High Court recently dismissed a petition challenging the citizenship and parliamentary membership of the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, after the petitioner failed to produce documentary evidence to support his allegations that he holds British nationality.

A Division Bench comprising Justice Shekhar B. Saraf and Justice Abdhesh Kumar Chaudhary permitted petitioner-in-person Ashok Pandey to withdraw the writ petition on August 31.

The petitioner had alleged that Mr. Gandhi incorporated a U.K.-based company, M/s Backops Limited, in 2003, and declared himself director and major shareholder, as well as a British national.

The High Court observed that while the petitioner's initial arguments appeared "very attractive" and capable of having "far-reaching consequences", he failed to produce documentary material when asked to substantiate his claims.

"... when he was asked as to what the basis of his aforesaid submission was, the petitioner could not show a single document relating to the formation of the company or records from the Registrar of Companies of Britain or any declaration to the effect that the aforesaid Shri Rahul Gandhi @ Raul Vinci has declared himself to be a British Citizen. The only document relied upon by the petitioner-in-person is some alleged letter of confirmation issued by the University of Cambridge certifying the study of one Raul Vinci, which according to this Court does not in any manner prove any of the allegations being contested in the present petition," the court noted while dismissing the petition.

What's the reason behind the sudden surge in onion prices?

EXPLAINER

A. M. Jigeesh
NEW DELHI

The story so far: Days after sugar prices increased sharply, the price of onion, an essential commodity whose prices are considered a politically sensitive topic, nearly doubled from last year's.

On September 1, the all-India average price was ₹49.59 a kg, registering an over 74% increase from ₹28.48 on the corresponding day in 2025.

On August 1, the price was ₹35.47 a kg. In Kolkata and Chennai, the price has now reached ₹60. What has worried the Centre is the fact that over the past two weeks, the price has gone beyond ₹70 in certain retail markets, particularly in North India. This increase is unprecedented, and according to some offi-



Big farmers, traders try to keep the stock in cold storage, hoping to release it at better prices. PTI

cials, has left the Centre searching for reasons behind this surge, as the Opposition says the government has failed to curb the price rise of essentials.

What could be reason for the increase?

The production of onion is estimated at 307.37 lakh tonnes (lt) in 2025-26, which is in line with the previous year's production of 307.67 lt. The produc-

tion is adequate for the domestic consumption and for export, which comes to about 15 lt. However, industry sources claim that the quality of onions, particularly after the delay in the rain and the subsequent delay in harvest in Maharashtra (the largest onion producing State), was not up to the standard. The fact that quality onions are less than last year is considered a reason for the price rise.

Historically, according to the government, onion prices have exhibited a seasonal uptick and volatility from August-September owing to increased demand during festive season, weather, supply-chain movements, and other demand conditions.

This year, as soon as the price of sugar increased, there was a tendency not to release the onion stocks, particularly among the big traders. Union Agriculture

Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan and Union Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare have outlined hoarding and black marketing as the reasons for the sudden increase in the prices of onion.

What steps are being taken to ease the prices?

As it is natural for traders and big farmers to look for better prices of what they produce and sell, the government says that it was expecting such a problem in the case of onions. Big farmers and big traders try to keep the stock in cold storage, hoping to release it when prices are right.

To counter this, the government has started a calibrated release of onion from its buffer stocks. It is selling onions at ₹35 a kg, to give a message to the consumer that it is the real price of onion and put pressure on those hoarding it, a senior official said.

Bhupathi: from dreaded Maoist to Gondwana University coordinator

Vinava Deshpande Pandit
GADCHIROLI/MUMBAI

Life has taken a dramatic turn for Bhupathi, also known by the aliases Abhay, Mallojula Venugopal, and Sonu. Once a dreaded Maoist with a bounty of ₹6 crore on his head and wanted by the police in six States, he is now looking at a very different future. Less than a year after surrendering before the Maharashtra Police, a move that dealt a major blow to Maoist insurgency in the State, the 70-year-old is preparing for a new chapter in life.

"I am the first person to end Maoism in this country. But what were we doing? There was no personal rivalry between the Maoists and the government. We were representing the tribals. We fought with the system as the representatives of the adivasis. Conflicts will stay till



Bhupathi. VINAVA DESHPANDE PANDIT

the tribals don't feel safe. Conflicts will stay till there are no radical changes, till there is no real rehabilitation for the tribals," he told *The Hindu* in Gadchiroli.

When *The Hindu* spoke with him, he was awaiting the result of the interview he had given for the position of a coordinator at the Village Council Capacity Building and Training Centre at Gondwana University. He has now been selected for the post.

According to the University notification, the coor-

dinators will visit villages in Gadchiroli district to supervise the functioning of the Gram Sabhas and to create awareness among the local tribal communities of their rights, particularly under forest-related legislation such as the Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act (PESA). They will receive a monthly stipend of ₹30,000 and travel allowance.

For tribal rights

"Many tribals are not aware about their rights. Why did we come out of the movement? Because we could not work for people, with arms. To struggle for them, we came out. We have left arms now. There are different ways of working," he said, adding that he was not inclined to join any mainstream political party either, despite getting several invites. He also refused the possibility of forming a political party.

He expressed concern about the government acquiring fertile land of the tribal communities for development projects.

Last year, Bhupathi's letters, distributed widely among the Maoist cadre of the erstwhile 'Red Corridor', had led to many insurgents giving up arms. Sixty of them surrendered along with him on October 15, 2025, in the presence of Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis.

When asked about the interview for the current job, he spoke about his disconnect with the system. "I was asked when PESA was enacted. I said it was legislated in 1996. Then I was asked when the PESA Rules were made. I did not know that they were made a whopping 12 years after the law was made. Who makes rules 12 years after bringing in a law? Why weren't the rules made then itself?" he asked.

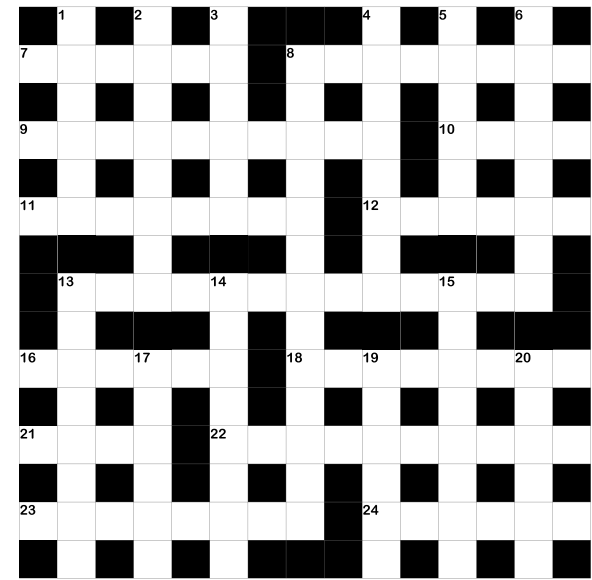
THE HINDU

CROSSWORD+ 14889

(set by Saral)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY



12. Sweet-sounding music for two including originally lovely contralto (6)
13. One in French hotel caught with director actively stopping reel continuously (5,3,5)
16. Minister from new circle (6)
18. Reverend's double course rejected (5,3)
21. Delay report covering lecture essentially (4)
22. Rag this ordinary garden parties perhaps (10)
23. Old relative in favour of European support (8)
24. Upset Republican bumping boxer's head in combat (6)

DOWN

1. Son to get cut nut for swimmer (6)
2. Note: Butter is used primarily in dessert (8)
3. Paper from government issued (6)
4. Irregular distribution of aid blocking yields in return (8)
5. Tour starts to take relatives around various enjoyable locations (6)
6. King, born idiot giving reaction without thinking (4-4)
8. Without being detected abused a thread run about the German (5,3,5)
13. Maybe sister in joy backing brother in the end (8)
14. Crack and lit heroin piece inhaled by doctor (8)
15. Tough to persuade bud sadly controlled by old judge (8)
17. Verses in religious education listing chants ignoring number (6)
19. Again chase passion and shine (6)
20. Working in underpass initially dark (6)

SUDOKU

			5		3	8		
	7		4			3		
	8	2				1		4
						6	9	5
				1				
6	5	4						
9		1				4	2	
		5			6		8	
		7	1		2			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

FAITH

Unconditional dependence

Bhakti yoga is highly recommended for devotees as an achievable goal in the Kali Yuga. There are two types of devotees: those who worship an idol/archa murti etc and those who pray to the imperishable, the indefinable, the omnipresent, the unthinkable, the unchangeable, the eternal and the unmanifested. People pray as per their appetite, but the object of devotion is the same, said Swami Sivayoganandhaji.

Lord Krishna tells Arjuna that whosoever's mind is fixed upon Him, everyday, every moment, with complete faith in Him, trusting Him totally with unconditional dependence is the best exponent of yoga (Ch XII, verse 2). There are three types of worshippers. First is the ordinary devotee who is important to himself, always analysing what he would get out of it for himself (focus is not on God). Second comes the kind who says both he and God are equally important in this relationship. The third kind is the devotee who says he is not important at all and whether God fulfills his wishes or not is entirely up to Him. Like the gopikas of Brindavan whose minds were always fixed on Krishna with no expectations of reward, and the last type of devotee prays to God because God is everything to him. Such a person is confident that the God who created him and given everything, would know when to give and when not to. One may wonder how to discipline one's mind, since it has a tendency to wander away from Him often, straying towards worldly affairs. Just as how water tends to travel downstream, our minds too will turn in the direction of our thoughts. One should be like Bhishma, considered to be among the top 11 bhakti acharyas.

Hong Kong activist Joshua Wong pleads guilty to 'foreign collusion'



'Mechanism needed for Black Sea safety before grain crisis escalates'



11 injured in Kyiv as Russian attacks continue for seventh straight day



Congo's Ebola outbreak shows no signs of slowing; deaths top 3,000



Iran fires on its Gulf neighbours in retaliation for renewed U.S. strikes

Hopes of finding survivors dim week after Nepal flood

U.S.-Sri Lanka operation busts drug network

Taliban defend ban on protests, saying it 'does not exist in Islamic law system'



Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB)
 Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Paryatan Bhawan, Near O.N.G.C. Halipad,
 Nimbubwala, Garhi Cantt, Dehradun - 248003 (UK)
 Ph. 0135-2559898, Fax 135-2559988

Ref. No. 3230/2-7-1020/2026-27 Dated: 02 September, 2026

UTDB invites tender for Supply of Ski Equipment to the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB), Dehradun, Uttarakhand

Details may be obtained on website: uktenders.gov.in and uttarakhandtourism.gov.in from 3:00 PM on 03.09.2026. Prospective Bidders may seek clarification till 03:00 PM on 08.09.2026 through E-mail: adventurewingutdb@gmail.com with CC to procurement.utdb@gmail.com. Any Addendum/Corrigendum including date extension will be uploaded only on uktenders.gov.in. Bids must be submitted online through uktenders.gov.in only. The last date for submission of bids is 26.09.2026 till 15:00 PM.

Chief Executive Officer

EALA MANIA

‘We’re very loud when it comes to supporting our people’



AP Alex Eala's fans arrived in huge numbers when she trained and then played in her first round US Open match. One of them was Andrea Belen, who FaceTimed with her father during the session so he could see Eala. “Everyone went crazy. We’re very loud when it comes to supporting our people,” said Belen.

DOUBLY SWEET

To play on the day of my 40th birthday was special: Monfils



AFF Gael Monfils stood in the middle of the court and bowed to the crowd that treated the Frenchman to a roaring ovation on his 40th birthday. “To play on the day of my 40th birthday was special. You guys made it incredible,” said Monfils to the fans at the Louis Armstrong Stadium, who sang happy birthday to him.

SHOWTIME

Frodin, Serena’s body double in King Richard, hogs the limelight



AP Thea Frodin once had to hit like Serena Williams in the King Richard movie in 2021. On Tuesday at the US Open, the 17-year-old showed some pretty good power of her own in real life. “Being aggressive has always been my game. Hopefully, the next time I meet her [Rybakina], I will see what I can do,” said Frodin.

IN THE HOTSEAT

Red Bull’s Lawson to race in Italian GP as injury keeps Hadjar out



REUTERS Liam Lawson will remain Max Verstappen’s teammate at Red Bull for the Italian GP after Isack Hadjar failed to recover in time from his wrist injury, the team confirmed. Hadjar had said he was hopeful of returning for Sunday’s race but will now miss a second event. Yuki Tsunoda gets a second race with Racing Bulls in Lawson’s seat.

Zverev battles back from the brink to subdue Sonogo

The top-seeded German was two points from defeat in the fourth set; French Open runner-up Cobolli also wins five-set marathon; Rybakina and Gauff move up with ease on rain-affected day

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

Top-seeded Alexander Zverev survived a scare, overcoming Lorenzo Sonogo in a wild-five setter at the US Open on Tuesday as Elena Rybakina and Coco Gauff advanced with ease.

Zverev fought off a determined challenge from Italy’s lowly ranked Sonogo, winning 6-4, 3-6, 6-7(7), 7-5, 6-4 in a tense all-court battle spiced by unlikely retrievals, impossibly angled winners and some inexplicable errors, which wrapped up on Arthur Ashe Stadium after four hours and 53 minutes at 1:55 in the morning.

“I’m just happy I won, that’s it. Incredible battle,” said Zverev, who was two points from defeat trailing 5-4 in the fourth set.

The German held serve and broke Sonogo in the next game, then earned the lone break of the fifth set to complete the win.

Fifth-seeded Flavio Cobolli, runner-up to Zverev at Roland Garros, rallied from two sets down for the first time in his career to beat Argentina’s Francisco Comesana 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4.

Nerves didn’t seem to be a problem for ninth-seeded Taylor Fritz as he sailed past fellow American Darwin Blanch 6-3, 6-2, 6-4.

There was no such drama for women’s World No. 2 Rybakina and former champion Gauff. Rybakina, eyeing a third Grand Slam title and the top ranking, beat US teen Thea Frodin



REUTERS Finding his range: Zverev conjured up unlikely retrievals and hit impossibly angled winners.

IMPORTANT RESULTS

Men: Second round: 7-Medvedev bt Gorznyi (USA) 6-1, 6-3, 7-5; Michelsen (USA) bt 16-Nakashima (USA) 6-3, 6-4, 6-4. First round: 1-Zverev (Ger) bt Sonogo (Ita) 6-4, 3-6, 6-7(7), 7-5, 6-4; 13-Musetti (Ita) bt Fery (GBR) 6-3, 6-3, 7-5; 9-Fritz (USA) bt Blanch (USA) 6-3, 6-2, 6-4; 24-Cerundolo (Arg) bt Misolic (Aut) 6-4, 6-3, 7-5; 5-Cobolli (Ita) bt Comesana (Arg) 3-6, 2-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4. Women: Second round: 19-Paolini (Ita) bt Stefanini (Ita) 6-4, 6-1; 31-Fernandez (Can) bt Sawangkaew (Tha) 6-4, 6-1; 15-Shnaider bt Pliskova (Cze) 6-1, 6-3, 6-2.

Gauff showed off her immensely improved serve in a confident 6-3, 6-4 victory over 53rd-ranked Zeynep Sonmez of Turkey. Gauff blazed through the opening set before Sonmez upped her game, recovering an early break in the second and briefly tak-

ing the lead before Gauff regrouped. Kazakhstan’s Rybakina showed little sign of the left heel injury that forced her out of her quarterfinal in Cincinnati this month. She saved both break points she faced in a polished performance against the big-hitting if erratic American, who was playing her first Grand Slam main draw match on a wild card.

Women’s French Open champion Mirra Andreeva also advanced easily, cruising past Indonesia’s 36th-ranked Janice Tjen 6-2, 6-2. Keys, a former Australian Open winner who lost in the first round at Flushing Meadows last year, conquered first-match jitters to beat 19-year-old Russian Alina Korneeva 7-5, 6-4.

While play went as scheduled on the covered Ashe and Armstrong stadiums, those on outside courts – including Rybakina – had to wait out some lengthy rain delays.

That included a near four-hour delay to the start of play and more delays in the evening. Five late matches were postponed altogether and a handful of others suspended.

For the current generation of cricket fans, Tilak Varma’s image is that of a dashing, short-format batter for India and Mumbai Indians. But over the last four days in the Duleep Trophy, the 23-year-old revealed another face – that of a steely red-ball player.

Captaining South Zone in the semifinal versus North, he made an unbeaten 116 from 250 balls to rescue his side from a precarious 80 for five. In the second essay, he was unconquered on 51 (79b) as South chased 181 with ease.

“I have always loved red-ball cricket,” Tilak said after his match-winning performance.

“I had never dreamt of playing white-ball [cricket] for India, but it’s God’s plan that I have played T20 and One-day for India. But my strength is the red-ball game.”

Numbers back this assertion. Though he has featured in just two First Class matches in the last 11 months, the Hyderabad southpaw has scored 1,729

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

An omnipresent Tilak Varma fashioned South Zone’s entry into the 2026-27 Duleep Trophy final with a thumping seven-wicket triumph over North Zone at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here. The 23-year-old from Hyderabad, who had starred in the first innings with an ultra-patient, unbeaten 116 (250b), scored a breezy half-century (51 n.o., 79b, 8x4) on Wednesday to help South chase 181 and set up a final date with East Zone in Chennai starting this Sunday.

Tilak first batted during a nervous few minutes towards the end of day one. He then occupied the crease for the whole of day two, helped swell South’s first-innings lead to 117 on day three before coming up with a first-rate finishing act on the final day.

And when he was not batting, he was marshalling his team’s resources as cap-



K. MURALI KUMAR The orchestrators: After Nidheesh restricted North’s lead, South skipper Tilak, left, took over.

tain, making it an all-encompassing show.

North began the final morning from 256 for seven, ahead by 139 runs. But Kerala pacer M.D. Nidheesh cleaned up the tail to

claim his 10th First Class five-wicket haul (five for 56) and limit North’s lead to under 200.

A 64-run, opening-wicket partnership between Ricky Bhui (42, 53b, 7x4)

and N. Jagadeesan (43, 83b, 4x4) set South on course before Tilak and R. Smaran (32 n.o., 42b, 4x4, 1x6) combined for an unbroken 80-run stand.

Tilak drove beautifully, almost always getting to the pitch of the ball and caressing the red cherry. His batting range could be seen in the back-to-back fours off left-arm spinner Abid Mushtaq, one reverse-swept and the other padded. North was tardy on the field. There were misfields galore, and as many as 12 byes, with Kanhaiya Wadhawan and Abdul Samad alternating wicket-keeping duties. The spiciest moment came when pacer Gurnoor Brar was livid with Wadhwan for dropping Jagadeesan on 14. It would have helped if Brar’s aggression had percolated through the side, but it never did.

The scores: North Zone 195 & 297 in 72.4 overs (Sanat Sangwan 76, Ayush Doseja 52, M.D. Nidheesh 5/56) lost to South Zone 312 & 182/3 in 43.1 overs (Ricky Bhui 42, N. Jagadeesan 43, Tilak Varma 51 n.o.).

Tilak says he wants to play in the final

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

South Zone skipper Tilak Varma expressed hope that he would be able to play the Duleep Trophy final against East Zone in Chennai starting this Sunday despite the short turnaround time between the marquee contest and the first T20I versus Afghanistan.

Tilak, who is India’s T20 vice-captain, will have to finish the final on September 10 and travel to Delhi for the international game scheduled for the 13th. East skipper Ishan Kishan and his deputy Vaibhav Sooryavanshi are also in the same boat.

“I want to play in the final,” Tilak told reporters on Wednesday after the triumph over North Zone. “We have two days break in between. But it depends

on the selectors and the management.”

Tilak hoped that speedster Vidwath Kaverappa, who didn’t take the field starting from the post-tea session on day three (Tuesday), will be available.

“His [left] ankle is slightly swollen, but he can walk and he is also running with a tape. I feel he will be there in the final. But let’s see.”

Karnataka stalwart Karun Nair, who scored 699 runs in the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy, was benched for the semifinal to accommodate Hyderabad’s K. Himateja. Tilak said it was purely because of team combination.

“North had two left-arm spinners, and we wanted a lefty in the middle-order. Himateja is a youngster (24) and has scored decent runs (485). It was very unfortunate for Karun.”

Mumbai, Vadodara to host first women’s CT

Agencies
DUBAI

The International Cricket Council (ICC) announced on Wednesday that the inaugural women’s Champions Trophy 2027 will be held in Mumbai and Vadodara from Feb. 14 to 28.

Top six outfits

Mumbai’s Cricket Club of India (CCI) and the Vadodara International Cricket Stadium will be the venues for the tournament which will bring together six of

the world’s top sides – Australia, England, India, New Zealand, South Africa and Sri Lanka. The teams, which qualified as per their ICC T20I rankings on the July 6 qualification cut-off date, will play in a round-robin league. The top two will progress to the final on February 28.

“With a marquee ICC women’s event now taking place every year, we have an opportunity to build greater momentum for the women’s game,” said Jay Shah, ICC chairman.

Stakeholders to meet today to chart India’s roadmap till ODI World Cup

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) will convene a critical stock-taking meeting of key stakeholders of India’s men’s cricket teams at its headquarters here on Thursday.

It is understood that the meeting will seek to take a deep dive into the issues that have affected India’s performances of late and chart a roadmap through to next year’s ODI World Cup, including a possible extension of chief selector Ajit Agarkar’s tenure.

Multiple sources in the BCCI have confirmed that head coach Gautam Gambhir, Agarkar, Centre of Excellence head of cricket V.V.S. Laxman, captains Shubman Gill and Shreyas



Agarkar’s extension as chief selector will be discussed. FILE PHOTO: EMMANUEL YOGINI

Iyer, and BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia will attend the meeting in person. Two key BCCI executives are also expected to be present, while some other office-bearers may join via videoconference.

Having taken charge in July 2023, Agarkar’s current contract expires at the

end of this month. With BCCI regulations capping a selector’s tenure at four years, he is eligible to continue until next September.

That would ensure continuity through the ODI World Cup, scheduled to begin in October 2027. However, India’s poor returns in ODIs and the cold war between Agarkar and the BCCI hierarchy over Rohit Sharma’s future in international cricket are likely to feature in the deliberations.

The injury-management mechanism at the CoE is another area that has come under criticism from the selection committee and team management. As a result, despite the recent PR overdrive around the CoE, BCCI office-bearers are keen to proactively come

up with a plan for a more effective injury-management system.

Scheduling overlaps between key India-A and international assignments and major domestic fixtures are also expected to be discussed. India-A’s shadow tour of New Zealand coinciding with the ODI series against the Kiwis has left little room for adequate Test preparation ahead of the crucial series in November.

The poor run of the limited-overs teams in Ireland and England will also come under detailed scrutiny. Saikia had announced a review meeting immediately after the England tour concluded in mid-July, but it could not be convened because of the unavailability of key personnel.

INBRIEF



‘Humiliated’ Aubameyang quits Gabon national team

Gabon captain Pierre-Emerick Aubameyang has announced that he is stepping back from the national team, saying he felt “humiliated” by his exclusion and subsequent reinstatement after the 2025 Africa Cup of Nations in Morocco. The top scorer in the history of the Panthers was singled out by the Gabonese government as responsible for the AFCON failure. “They humiliated and smeared me even though I played at the AFCON while injured,” the 37-year-old said.

Anahat and Ramit advance in London Squash Classic

Reigning World junior champion Anahat Singh eased past Egypt’s Mariam Metwally 11-3, 11-2 to enter the second round of the \$144,000 London Squash Classic. In the men’s first round, Ramit Tandon defeated Qatar’s Abdullah Al-Tamimi 11-6, 11-7 but Veer Chotrani lost to Yannick Wilhelmi of Switzerland 9-11, 9-11.

Women in Blue keen to iron out batting flaws

The seven-time champion would look for a better performance ahead of its game against Pakistan on Saturday; Hong Kong’s Lamplough will be the bowler to watch out for in Thursday’s match

ASIA CUP

Press Trust of India
DUBAI

India will need to sort out its batting frailties for a more complete performance when it faces Hong Kong in its second match of the Women’s T20 Asia Cup on Thursday.

The seven-time champion survived some anxious moments after a batting collapse in the second half of the first innings in its opening match against Thailand.

Leeway

India will have more leeway to iron out its issues ahead of bigger battles, including against Pakistan in its last Group A-game.

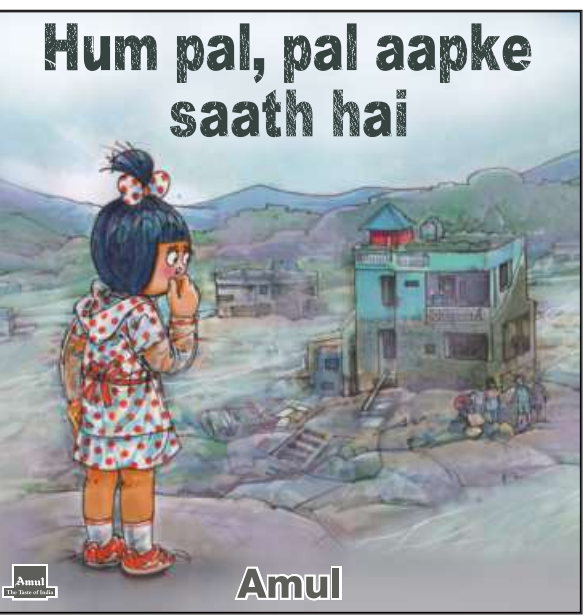
Shafali Verma shone brightly with a quick-fire 64, while Deepti Sharma too proved her mettle, tak-



Practice makes perfect: Harmanpreet & Co. gear up for the Hong Kong game. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ing three wickets without conceding a run to emerge as the highest wicket-taker

in women’s T20Is. Smriti Mandhana and Pratika Rawal will hope to



Wadoo is head coach of India u-17 men’s team

FOOTBALL

ANI
NEW DELHI

The AIFF has appointed former India international Mehrajuddin Wadoo as the head coach of the India u-17 men’s national team. Wadoo has taken charge of

the team as the Blue Colts began their preparatory camp in Margao on Wednesday. The camp is in its trial phase as preparations begin for the AFC u-17 Asian Cup Uzbekistan 2027 Qualifiers. India has been drawn in Group E of the Qualifiers, which will be held in Kuala Lumpur from November 11 to 20.

Parkinson’s Law, Butterfly Effect and the beautiful chaos of deadline day

PL TRANSFERS

Sankar Narayanan E.H.

Every deadline day is an opportunity to remember Parkinson’s Law.

C. Northcote Parkinson’s 1955 satirical observation that work expands to fill the time available for its completion was validated once again as English clubs squeezed every last second of the clock before the Premier League summer transfer window closed at 3.30 a.m. IST on Wednesday.

The biggest (read costliest) deadline-day move came as Argentina midfielder Enzo Fernandez swapped Chelsea’s royal blue for Manchester City’s lighter shade.

The £125 million deal came after the London outfit had reportedly set an August 14 deadline for the player it valued at £120 million. In the end, Man City got its man, and Chelsea pocketed a tidy profit on a player it bought for £107 million in 2023.

Chain reaction

Waiting until the very last moment is risky business, especially when the whole ecosystem relies on a deli-



News and newsmakers: While Fernandez swapped Chelsea’s royal blue for Manchester City’s lighter shade, Fofana was at the centre of one of the most dramatic transfers. X@MNCITY & INSTAGRAM@MALICK FOFANA

cate chain reaction.

A player’s transfer from one badge to another doesn’t just affect the two clubs involved. The ripple effect of that one signature may disrupt or open avenues for other teams and players in the ecosystem, setting off or cancelling a slew of incomings and outgoings by virtue of the original transfer.

In other words, Ray Bradbury’s Butterfly Effect, too, assumes utmost

significance in the world of football.

Ask Chelsea, and it will tell you how it came close to signing Monaco’s Lamine Camara as Fernandez’s replacement, only for the French club to renege on the deal because of striker Folarin Balogun’s proposed departure to Everton bringing in enough cash to the club. In a late twist, Balogun chose not to move to Merseyside, a decision that left all three



of Chelsea, Monaco and Everton unhappy and blindsided!

Lyon’s Malik Fofana was at the centre of one of the most dramatic deadline day transfers. After Arsenal reportedly decided not to spend big on the Belgian winger, Sunderland and Crystal Palace entered the fray. According to reports, Fofana had two private jets waiting for him at Lyon airport, one set for Sunderland, and the other

for London. While Palace initially thought it had successfully hijacked Sunderland’s agreement with Fofana, the player ultimately decided to ply his trade at the Stadium of Light.

The 2026-27 Premier League deadline day had it all: a record-shattering transfer, two private jets on a runway, and a collapsed multi-club domino chain.

After all, what is deadline day without some chaos and manic buying?

Atiqa records two top-four finishes in WSK Final Cup

MOTORSPORTS

Press Trust of India
FRANCIACORTA (ITALY)

Indian racing prodigy Atiqa Mir overcame set-up issues to collect two impressive top-four finishes in the opening round of the WSK Final Cup here, continuing her upward trajectory in the world of karting.

The qualifying session didn’t go as per plan for the 11-year-old and she could only set the ninth fastest time.

However, the first Indian to be backed by the F1 Academy, made flying starts in both race one and two to charge through the field and secure creditable



Atiqa. X@FIA

back-to-back fourth place finishes. Following the two heat races, Atiqa was classified P14 among as many as 72 drivers.

This put her seventh on the grid for the pre-final where she eventually finished ninth after running fifth for the majority of the

race. In the final, Atiqa was involved in a crash that damaged her kart and ended her race.

“A mixed weekend for me. I was expecting more but we were struggling for pace.

“I managed to fight my way up in most of the races and was in a competitive spot for the pre finals and finals.

“But things didn’t go my way and the lack of pace hurt us on the long straights of Franciacorta,” said the JK Tyre and Raise-backed driver.

Atiqa will next be seen in the fourth round of the Champions of the Future Academy in Spain. She had dominated the Greece round earlier this year.

Stud Poker tipped for feature event

RACING

MYSURU: Stud Poker, who has been well prepared, is expected to score in the Srikanthadatta Narasimharajawadiyar Memorial Multi Million (1,400m), the feature event of the opening day races to be held here on Thursday (Sept. 3). False rails (width about 2m from 1,600m to the winning post) will be in position.

1. STAR OF MYSORE TROPHY (DIV. II), 1,400m, rated 20 to 45, 2-00 p.m.: 1. Lords Grace (4) R. Ravi 60, 2. Fine Silver (12) Akshay K 59.5, 3. King Scarface (2) Abhishek Mhatre 58.5, 4. Mighty Hero (1) Jitendra S 58.5, 5. Sneha Latha (3) S. Imran 58.5, 6. Elveden (8) Lakshman S 58, 7. Sada (5) Sai Kiran 58, 8. Your Sri Shakthi (11) Gautam Raj 58, 9. King D (9) A. Asbar 57.5, 10. Starlight Whisper (10) Mukesh 57, 11. Trump Baby (6) A. Bandaal 55 and 12. Supernal (7) Kiran Rai 54.5.

1. FINE SILVER, 2. SADA, 3. SUPERNAL

2. LAVASA PLATE (1,200m), rated 00 to 25, 2:30: 1. Calculus (12) S. Sachin 62.5, 2. Dasadyu (9) Ritesh G 61.5, 3. Excellence (4) Aleemuddin 61, 4. Anzac Parade (1) Abhishek Mhatre 60, 5. She’s So Beautiful (10) Ramesh K 60, 6. Everwin (6) Inayat 59.5, 7. Rock My Heart (7) B. Darshan 59, 8. Saintly Star (2) S. Shareef 59, 9. Wild Child (11) Sai Kiran 59, 10. Nizbati Queen (3) Gautam Raj 58,

11. Moonlight Speed (8) Siddharaju P 55.5 and 12. Lorven’s Glory (5) M. Rajesh K 52.5.

1. EXCELLENCE, 2. DASADYA, 2. ANZAC PARADE

3. STAR OF MYSORE TROPHY (DIV. I), 1,400m, rated 20 to 45, 3-00: 1. Auspicious King (1) Kiran Rai 61.5, 2. One Diamond (6) Faiz 61.5, 3. Golden Sabre (3) N. Darshan 61, 4. Bezawada Baasha (8) Sai Kiran 60.5, 5. Yarra Yarra (2) Antony 60, 6. Krishvi (10) Inayat 59.5, 7. Shutterfly (5) Sandesh 59, 8. Super Stride (4) Abhishek Mhatre 58, 9. Sarvottam (11) R. Rakesh 57, 10. Jasmine (9) Salman Khan 56, 11. Words Worth (12) B. Darshan 56, 12. Born Ruler (7) A. Asbar 55.5.

1. SHUTTERFLY, 2. YARRA YARRA, 3. AUSPICIOUS KING

4. B.K. KRISHNADEVARAJ URS MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I), 1,200m, rated 40 to 65, 3-30: 1. Asio (3) S. Shareef 62, 2. Spectacular (12) Sai Kiran 61.5, 3. Raffinato (1) Md. Talib 61, 4. Winter Agenda (7) Antony 61, 5. Rapius (8) S. Imran 60.5, 6. Serrano (4) Rushal G.A. 60.5, 7. Shibra (5) A. Asbar 60.5, 8. Falcon Fury (2) Abhishek Mhatre 59, 9. Grizzly (6) Ramesh K 59, 10. Silver Spring (11) Rajesh K 58, 11. Beautiful Bloom (9) Prabhu K 56.5 and 12. Zephyrine (10) Akshay K 53.5.

1. ZEPHYRINE, 2. SHIBRA, 3. WINTER AGENDA

5. SRIKANTADATTA NARASIMHARAJAWADIYAR MEMORIAL MULTI MILLION (1,400m), 3-y-o only, (Terms), 4-00: 1. Enrica (5)

Akshay K 57, 2. Seize The Grey (4) Sandesh 55.5, 3. Stud Poker (3) Antony 55.5, 4. Astrid (1) Trevor 54 and 5. Tyche (2) Neeraj 54.

1. STUD POKER, 2. TYCHE

6. H.H. SRI JAYACHAMARAJ WADIYAR MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,200m), rated 80 & above, 4-30: 1. Huntingdon (7) Inayat 60.5, 2. Czar (3) Antony 60, 3. Gold Kite (8) Md. Talib 60, 4. Yukan (6) Lave Kumar 58, 5. Rise Again (5) Sai Kiran 57.5, 6. Touch Of Grey (9) Akshay K 57, 7. Star Glory (10) Darshan 56, 8. Masato (2) Rayan 56, 9. Tom Cruiser (1) Salman Khan 53.5 and 10. Vandhiyathevan (4) Faiz 53.5.

1. CZAR, 2. MASATO, 3. STAR GLORY

7. B.K. KRISHNADEVARAJ URS MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II), 1,200m, rated 40 to 65, 5-00: 1. Cynosure (11) N. Darshan 60, 2. Mandolin (6) S. Sachin 59, 3. Moonlight Queen (10) Faiz 57.5, 4. Balgownie (7) Inayat 57, 5. Choice (3) B. Darshan 56.5, 6. Mark One (4) Md. Talib 56.5, 7. Saint Emillion (8) Aleemuddin 56, 8. Windborne (9) A. Hangal 55.5, 9. Selma (5) Antony 55, 10. Sira (2) R. Rakesh 55, 11. Marzgoval (1) S. Imran 54.5 and 12. Straordinario (12) Bharat Mal 54.5.

1. SELMA, 2. MARZGOVAL, 3. MARK ONE

Day’s best: **STUD POKER** Double: **FINE SILVER** — **EXCELLENCE**

Jkt: 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7; Mini Jkt: 4, 5, 6 and 7; Tr (1): 2, 3 and 4; (ii): 5, 6 and 7.

Srikanth, Tanvi advance; Lakshya exits

BADMINTON

Press Trust of India
SHENZHEN

K. Srikanth and Tanvi Sharma registered straight-game wins to progress to the second round while Lakshya Sen was knocked out of the China Masters after a listless performance in the opening round on Wednesday.

Srikanth progressed after beating Taiwan’s Chi Yu Jen 21-16, 21-15 in a men’s singles opener while Tanvi, defeated Denmark’s Amalie Schulz 21-16, 21-17.

Lakshya played an error-riddled game to go down 14-21, 7-21 in 38 minutes to Victor Lai.

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty also moved to the next round

with a 21-11, 21-16 win over Malaysia’s Junaidi Arif and Kang Khai Xing.

India’s mixed doubles pair of Dhruv Kapila and Tanisha Crasto too entered the next round after defeating Thailand’s Tonnakorn Saehng and Tonicha Saeheng 21-8, 21-9.

The results (first round):

Women: Tanvi Sharma bt Amalie Schulz (Den) 21-16, 21-17; Kaloyana Nalbantova (Bul) bt Devika Sihag 21-18, 21-15.

Men: K. Srikanth bt Chi Yu Jen (Tpe) 21-16, 21-15; Victor Lai (Can) bt Lakshya Sen 21-14, 21-7.

Doubles: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty bt Junaidi Arif and Kang Khai Xing (Mal) 21-11, 21-16.

Mixed doubles: Dhruv Kapila & Tanisha Crasto bt Tonnakorn Saehng and Tonicha Saehng (Tha) 21-8, 21-9; Wu Guan Xun & Lee Chia Hsin (Tpe) bt Rohan Kapoor & Ruthvika Gadde 21-16, 21-18.

KARNATAKA ROUND-UP

Aneesh and Anvay prop up KSCA President’s XI

BENGALURU: K.V. Aneesh (76) and Anvay Dravid (43) kept KSCA President’s XI afloat against Goa CA on the second day of their Dr. (Capt.) K. Thimmappiah memorial tournament match at M. Chinnaswamy Stadium on Wednesday. KSCA President’s XI trails Goa CA by 128 runs, with three wickets in hand.

The scores: At Bengaluru: Goa CA 338 in 102.2 overs vs. KSCA President’s XI 210/7 in 72 overs (K.V. Aneesh 76, Anvay Dravid 43). Gujarat CA 350 in 95.1 overs (Abhishek Desai 101, Vedant Trivedi 50, Priyesh Patel 64, Parth Rekha 7/77) vs. Vidarbha CA 265/7 in 79 overs (Satyam Bhojar 41, Abhishek Agrawal 52, Yash Kadam 50, Saral Prajapati 5/71). KSCA Secretary’s XI 303 vs. Baroda CA 309/8 in 97.0 overs (Sukrit Pandey 59, Shivalik Sharma 155 n.o.).

Madhya Pradesh CA 290/9 decl. in 93.4 overs (Yash Dubey 69, Shubham Sharma 105) vs. Chhattisgarh State Cricket Sangh 217/4 in 74 overs (Anuj Tiwari 83, Sanidhya Hurkat 55).

KSCA XI 361 and 59/1 in 19 overs vs. Maharashtra CA 216 in 65.5 overs (Siddesh Veer 86, Madhav Bajaj 4/55).

UT Cricket Association (Chandigarh) 426/5 in 120 overs (Manav Vohra 163, Raj Angad 103) vs. Mumbai CA 144/1 in 56 overs (Angkirsh Raghuvanshi 71 n.o.).

overs (Akash Vashisht 91, Pukhraj Mann 137).

Mokhit notches up a century for Bangalore City XI

K.S. Mokhit (142) starred for Bangalore City XI against Dharwad Zone in the KSCA under-19 inter-zonal tournament here.

The scores: Dharwad Zone 303 in 75.5 overs (Sujoy Korawar 104, Sainath Rajoli 89) drew with Bangalore City XI 318/9 in 89 overs (M. Jayan Samyog 62, K.S. Mokhit 142, S.B. Patil 6/58). Shivamogga Zone 155 in 39.1 overs and 83/1 in 20 overs drew with Mangalore Zone 231 in 60.5 overs (A.S. Kumar 41, Davin Glenn Mascarenhas 48).

President’s XI 235/7 decl. in 65.2 overs (Arya Gowda 105) drew with Mysore Zone 324/3 in 86 overs (Chavanth Gowda 91, Vyshak Nagaraj 76, Manthlan Arun 63, Varun Patel Lokesha 80 n.o.).

Raichur Zone 150 in 53.3 overs and 197/6 in 52 overs (Rajesh Mahadev Kamble 71, Abhilash Rathod 51 n.o.) drew with Bangalore Zone 234 in 56.3 overs (Arnav Anil 56, Dhruv Krishnan 70, Tejas Reddy 54, Rohit Rathod 4/44).

Tumkur Zone 205 in 70.3 overs (Adil 47) drew with Combined City XI 213 in 50.2 overs (Adhrit Rao 62, Arush Jain 66, K.S. Rohith 4/46).

Tejas in last eight

Top seed Tejas Ravi edged out Amrit Dhankar 6-3, 5-7, 6-1 to enter the quarterfinals of the KSLTA World Tennis Tour Junior J30 Bengaluru at the S.M. Krishna Tennis Stadium on Wednesday. In the

girls’ round-of-16, Disha Kumar defeated Tanussstri Maneni Sathesh 6-1, 6-2.

Zavaray Poonawalla to sponsor marquee Mysuru races

MYSURU: Zavaray S. Poonawalla will sponsor the Invitation Cup and the Mysore Derby in the 16-day Mysuru racing season beginning here on Thursday.

Mr. Poonawalla will also support the 1000 and 2000 Guineas, Mysore Dasara Sprint Championship and the Mysore Race Club Anniversary Cup.

Wherever the guaranteed stake money is not fully covered by the Mysore Race Club’s contribution and sweepstakes collections, the shortfall will be shared equally between Mr. Poonawalla and the club.

MRC chairman K.T. Balakrishna also revealed the advertised stake money for the season is approximately ₹7 crore, excluding the prize money for races conducted during the Invitation Cup weekend.

LIVE TELECAST

T20 Women’s Asia Cup: India vs Hong Kong, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 8 p.m.

US Open: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8:30 p.m. & 4:30 a.m. (Friday)
LaLiga: FanCode, 12.30 a.m. (Friday)

From the Wall to the Hall

Once a boy who broke racquets and scrubbed toilets for it, Federer turned a hot temper into quiet grace and routine brilliance into religion, becoming tennis' closest thing to a spiritual experience. In Newport on Sunday, the Hall of Fame simply made it scripture

Anirudh Velamuri

There should be a word for what Roger Federer did on a tennis court, because “played” barely covers it. Watching him felt like being granted a glimpse of the divine, and that’s no exaggeration. Your jaw went slack, your eyes bulged, and sounds escaped your body that no grown adult should make over a man hitting a felt ball with a string racquet.

Federer did not invent anything. Every shot in his arsenal had been struck before, by someone else in some other era.

Yet, in his hands, the borrowed became the sacred, the familiar became revelation, as if the shot had been waiting its whole life for him specifically to unlock it. And he didn’t do it once in some career-defining flash of magic. He did it for the better part of two decades. It was a residency in genius, not a hot streak. Pete Sampras once said Federer’s game had no weaknesses, and it stands true. What other players built entire careers on – a single jaw-dropping moment etched into a highlight reel – Federer treated as routine.

Except, of course, that routine came around roughly a thousand times, spread across four Grand Slams and every corner of the world, and it never once stopped feeling like the first time. That is the strange arithmetic of Federer’s greatness: repetition should have dulled the wonder, but it never did. Familiarity, in his case, only sharpened the awe.

Now the residency has its plaque. The felt ball has been put down, the sermons have ended, and what’s left is the reckoning every great career eventually meets – not a match, but a monument.

On Sunday, the world celebrated Federer once again as he was inducted into the International Tennis Hall of Fame. It is the sport’s great farewell and its eternal afterlife in the same breath, a place where a player’s brilliance is carved into permanence, even as it reminds them that greatness is never solitary.

The crowd said as much. Billie Jean King, Martina Navratilova, Stefan Edberg, John McEnroe, Andy Roddick and many others were on hand to celebrate one of tennis’ finest champions.

And closer still sat the ones who needed no introduction. His parents, Robert and Lynette. His wife, Mirka, and his four kids that the tennis world had watched grow up, one Slam at a time, in players’ boxes scattered across the globe—.

Mirka spoke first and introduced her husband with a line that outshone every statistic that followed. “What makes me proudest isn’t what Roger accomplished when the world was watching. It’s who he is when nobody’s watching,” she said.

He, too, glowingly praised the one person who has seen the highs and lows of his stardom from a touch away, while also building a semblance of a normal life together.

“Mirka inspires me every day. She showed me how to stay focused on tennis and take joy in everything else. A wonderful mother to our four kids... she makes the impossible happen. We grab each other’s hands, and we run through walls.”

More than trophies

For once, the man who made the impossible look routine was undone by his own history. He tried, and failed, to hold it together – pausing a few times to wipe his eyes, half-laughing through his tears. At one point, he pleaded for tissues and sunglasses, but pressed on anyway, the way he always had.

When he steadied himself enough, he spoke not of the trophies or numerous records. He was more focused on the more than 5,000 headbands he wore, the more than 7,000 pairs of socks he went through, some 10,000 racquets strung over the years, and the thousands of sets played on the same two knees.

“I tried to show my love for the game. Because it really mattered to me, and I also wanted it to matter to you. To be worthy of your attention, worthy of your attendance, because people don’t have to come watch us play. They come to be entertained, inspired, excited. They could always decide to go somewhere else, but they chose tennis, they chose us,” he emphasised.

The 45-year-old even wandered back to where it all began, not in any packed



stadium but in the shadows just off it.

“I remember being a ball boy in Basel, standing against the back wall, hands behind me, eyes on the ball. I’ll never forget how the game looked from there... the intensity, the adversity, the feeling of being so close to the players. I remember the next morning, my legs were gone... standing all day is a lot of work.”

Federer, especially later in his career, had the power to make the smallest cog in the wheel seen and appreciated. His core memory helped him do the same once more at Newport.

“I really want to thank every ball kid who ever stood through my matches or all our matches, for that matter, for hours on end. I see you. I thank you. I was you.”

It’s a strange, fitting symmetry: that is precisely how everyone felt watching his career unfold. Standing still, eyes fixed on the ball, absorbing the intensity as though they were pressed against the back wall of the court – even from several hundred or several thousand kilometres away, on the other side of the television screen.

More than a hundred titles in his cabinet, and yet Federer insisted the number was never the point.

“They call this the Hall of Fame... but fame was never the goal. My goal was to spend my life doing something I love, with people who love it as much as I do.”

And he did – relentlessly, joyfully, for the better part of his life. Federer didn’t just win; he took tennis to altitudes it hadn’t

reached before, wrote storylines the sport had never dared to script, and handed the world rivalries (with Rafael Nadal and Novak Djokovic) that will be studied and mythologised for generations.

Smashed racquet, softened man

There was a time when the future maestro was closer to a menace. As a boy in Basel, he didn’t play tennis so much as wage a war with it – swearing between points, smashing racquets and the whole kit and caboodle. At 16, he tore through a practice backdrop, understandably earning a week-long toilet-scrubbing sentence from his coach.

By his own admission, the unlearning took years and was no epiphany. The real turning point wasn’t a victory or defeat, but a tragedy – the death of his childhood coach Peter Carter in 2002, which recalibrated Federer for good.

Self-deprecation became an art form, just like most things would with Federer. The same man, on Sunday, would hold up two ageing knees to a crowd of legends and grin, saying, “Still got them, by the way. If I fall, please catch me.” The once hot-headed boy is now at ease with

laughing at himself, and became the most graceful man in tennis – on the court and off it. And he did it all with the same unhurried smile, even in the moments when the headband was fighting a losing battle against the sweat of another title run, even when his body was being pushed past what bodies are supposed to give.

“I’m still writing my love letter to tennis. My time as a player is done, but tennis will always stand at the intersection of everything I care most about... my family, our friendships, the past 40 years and the future we’re building. So this is not a goodbye,” he stated.

“We all leave the court eventually, but the sport keeps evolving. This boy from Basel thanks you... and I thank all of you for sharing the journey.”

It is the tennis world, though, that owes its thanks to Federer.

He carried the sport to spaces it had never been invited into before – into living rooms of people who couldn’t tell a forehand from a backhand, into the vocabulary of art critics and poets who had never once written about sport, into a kind of beauty that made the utilitarian business of winning feel almost secondary. He turned rivalry into reverence, opponents into co-authors, and a simple racquet into something closer to a paintbrush.

The ball boy became the main event. And the boy who once stood against the back wall, eyes fixed on the ball with hands behind his back, has finally taken his place among the very heroes he once watched from the shadows.

That, perhaps, is the only ending fitting enough: not a farewell, but a homecoming.

Career in numbers

1 The only male player to appear in seven consecutive Wimbledon finals (2003 to 2009)

8 Federer holds the record for most Wimbledon men’s singles titles

19 Grass was Federer’s most successful surface, where he won an Open Era record 19 titles (including a record 10 Halle Open titles)

20 Number of Grand Slam singles titles he won. He is the first man in history to reach the milestone

31 The number of Grand Slam finals reached (20-11 win-loss record)

56 His record win streak on hard courts (2005 ABN AMRO World Tennis Tournament in Rotterdam to the 2006 Dubai Duty Free Tennis Championships)

103 Number of career titles won

224 Career victories against top-10 opponents, with a 64.6 win percentage

237 Holds the record for most consecutive weeks as World No. 1 (February 2, 2004 to August 17, 2008)

310 Number of weeks spent as the top-ranked player in the world, second only to Djokovic (428)

1,526 The number of matches Federer played (won 1,251 and lost 275)

Moving towards a universal vaccine against pneumonia and meningitis

Scientists are looking for a universal pneumococcal vaccine that can target all the hundred or so forms of *Streptococcus pneumonia* bacteria, and prevent some undesirable outcomes created by existing vaccines that keep the threat of pneumococcal diseases alive in the human population

S. Swaminathan

There is a bacterium called *Streptococcus pneumoniae*. It comes in at least a hundred different forms, or serotypes, and lives in the tissue lining our nose and throat. *S. pneumoniae* is normally harmless. But when your body's immune system becomes weaker, for example when you have a viral fever, these bacteria may invade your lungs and cause pneumonia, your brain and spinal cord to cause meningitis, and your bloodstream to cause sepsis.

These diseases are called pneumococcal diseases, and fortunately, they can be prevented by vaccines. Each of these vaccines contains a unique sugary substance called a capsular polysaccharide, aimed at each serotype of *S. pneumoniae*. That is, they offer protection specific to each serotype.

And the current crop of pneumococcal vaccines protect against only a subset of the 100-odd serotypes. To increase coverage, scientists need to include additional serotype-specific capsular polysaccharides in the vaccine. And covering all the serotypes in a single shot would be extremely challenging, not to mention extremely expensive as well.

Sugary shot

Recently, a team of British scientists reported an important first step in this direction. They did two things: first, they switched the polysaccharide with proteins and, second, they adopted an approach called reverse vaccinology.

Basically, two kinds of pneumococcal vaccines are available today. One is a mix of purified capsular polysaccharides from multiple serotypes. Pneumovax 23 is an example. It does not work well in infants and offers short-lived protection.

To help boost the effects as well as the durability of the immune response, scientists have linked the polysaccharides to a carrier protein. Such vaccines are known as pneumococcal conjugate vaccines (PCVs). Typical examples include PCV10 and PCV14; the numerals denote the number of serotypes included.

When these vaccines target and eliminate some serotypes of *S. pneumoniae*, it also opens the door for other serotypes to mount an infection. These non-vaccine serotypes also face less biological competition for space and resources, so they multiply and eventually replace the vaccine-targeted serotypes, rendering the vaccines obsolete.

Second, many non-vaccine serotypes either possess antibiotic resistance genes or can acquire them from their resistant counterparts. This leads to the rise of both vaccine- and antibiotic-resistant serotypes.

Thus, scientists are looking for a universal pneumococcal vaccine that can target all serotypes and prevent these outcomes, which keep the threat of pneumonia, meningitis, and other pneumococcal diseases alive in the population.



The agar plate with red blood cells on the left shows a positive Staphylococcus infection and on the right shows a positive Streptococcus infection. NCI/UNSPASH

Reverse vaccinology starts from the germ's genome to identify proteins that can be included in vaccines. Scientists demonstrated an example of this in the recent COVID-19 pandemic: once the virus's genome was sequenced in early 2020, scientists around the world could analyse it and zero in on the spike-protein gene to make COVID-19 vaccines. The approach completely bypassed the need to culture the germs in large bioreactors and purify molecular components from them to make the vaccine.

The *S. pneumoniae* genome encodes more than 2,000 genes. Of them, around 1,300 are common across serotypes. The genomic data of more than 20,000 *S. pneumoniae* isolates across nearly a hundred serotypes are also available in the public domain.

The scientists deployed extensive computational analysis using an arsenal of bioinformatic tools to analyse these sequences.

They reasoned that the best candidate genes for creating their universal vaccine would need to encode for proteins with three attributes: (i) it must be located on the surface so that the immune system can easily access it; (ii) it must have low or no similarity to human proteins, so that the immune system does not attack the body's tissue, and (iii) it must be capable of eliciting a robust and durable anti-pneumococcal immunity.

The team shortlisted some candidates and further whittled the list down based on their predicted shapes and stability. From this, the team picked three

candidate genes. They were: zinc metalloprotease B (Z), pneumococcal adherence virulence factor A (P), and a protein which the scientists designated YfhO-like (Y) due to its similarity to another bacterial protein.

The team produced proteins Z, P, and Y in the laboratory and made an experimental vaccine by mixing them together. They also added two non-protein immune response boosters: a small piece of synthetic DNA called CpG and a sugary polymer called chitosan. They named this formulation ZPY-CpG-Ch.

Potent antibodies

To test whether the vaccine could elicit protective anti-pneumococcal antibodies, the scientists vaccinated laboratory mice. After some time, they exposed the mice to a lethal dose of *S. pneumoniae* serotype 1, which is known to be hypervirulent. Compared to unvaccinated mice, all of which succumbed to the lethal dose, vaccinated mice showed 80-100% survival.

Importantly, the scientists found that the level of protection offered by ZPY-CpG-Ch was comparable to that of PCV13.

The team also found that antibodies from the mice vaccinated with ZPY-CpG-Ch could help kill *S. pneumoniae* bacteria in a test tube. When injected into unvaccinated mice, the antibodies could also protect them against a lethal dose of serotype 1.

Third, ZPY-CpG-Ch fully protected

vaccinated mice exposed to lethal doses of two non-vaccine serotypes, 11A and 33F. It also offered 50% protection against a third non-vaccine serotype, called serotype 8.

In all mouse experiments, measures of the vaccine's protective effect based on the bacterial load in lungs and blood mirrored the rodents' survival rates. However, the ZPY-CpG-Ch vaccine did not reduce the load of pneumococcal bacteria in the upper respiratory passages of vaccinated mice. That is, despite being protected, vaccinated mice have the ability to still spread the infection to uninfected mice.

Worthy goal

Finally, the team also reported that vaccinating mice with ZPY-CpG-Ch stimulated a subset of immune cells that are implicated in pneumococcal immunity.

The results from this work are too preliminary for ZPY-CpG-Ch to be a universal pneumococcal vaccine. It has also been tested against a very small subset of serotypes, four to be precise. Vaccine data from laboratory mice also may not truly reflect the human situation.

Nevertheless, this work represents a baby step towards the worthy goal of developing a universal pneumococcal vaccine.

(S. Swaminathan is a retired professor of biology at BITS-Pilani, Hyderabad, and a former scientist at ICGEB, New Delhi. ssn225@gmail.com)



Scientist Akiko Takii collects samples from a young Asiatic black bear before releasing it back into the wild in Nagano, Japan, in July 2026. AFP

An alternative emerges to check Japan's bear troubles

Agence France-Presse

As a sensor sounded, scientist Akiko Takii hurried to a bear trap deep in the forests of Nagano in Japan, where rising attacks have brought fear and resulted in the culling of thousands of the animals. "It is a small bear, I think, about a year and a half old," Ms. Takii said as she peered at the 15-kilogramme Asiatic black bear thrashing in the cage. "It must have just parted from mum." Its mother was not around, and Ms. Takii took blood and fur samples after her co-researcher tranquilised the young female. The animal was too small to be tagged with a GPS tracker, so she was released.

The process of trapping, tagging, and releasing the animals is part of a pioneering management plan launched in 1995, as authorities realised the bear population was shrinking in the mountainous region in the centre of Japan's Honshu island. And it is becoming part of a model of coexistence in the region that some experts believe is an alternative to the dominant practice of culling the animals in an effort to prevent attacks. "By not killing too many of them, more bears survive to live out their expected lifespan. In that sense, a healthy bear population is being formed," Ms. Takii said of the process, which is paired with other methods intended to keep bears away from humans and monitor their movement.

Even before a cull guidance in Japan was expanded in April, large numbers of bears were being killed; however, several communities are embracing co-existence to prevent attacks

Another group in the area used specially trained Karelian Bear Dogs to scare bears away, and more than 3,000 kilometres of fencing was installed near farms, towns, and along rivers to prevent encounters. Bears who slip through are tranquilised, tagged, and set free far away. The programme has been credited with prompting both a recovery in bear numbers – although the animals are hard to count – and fewer encounters with humans.

There is little sympathy across much of Japan for healthy bear populations. Bears have killed six people nationwide since April 1, after a record 13 fatal attacks last fiscal year, according to the Environment Ministry. Sightings last year doubled the previous record and bears are increasingly entering the outskirts of towns and cities.

The causes are complex and, including variations in the availability of food like acorns, are potentially linked to climate change. The emptying out of rural areas due to depopulation and urbanisation is also leaving forests, farmland, and buffer zones less managed, said Shuichi Kitoh, a Tokyo University professor emeritus of environmental ethics. The government's response has focused largely on culling bears, expanding the process beyond animals in towns to those that wander into buffer zones on the outskirts. Even before the cull guidance was expanded in April, large numbers of bears were being killed – a record 14,000 last fiscal year, or almost 40 a day.

Ms. Takii argued Nagano's coexistence programme offered a different path.

While direct comparisons are difficult, some figures appear to show it has helped limit dangerous encounters. Annual sightings have remained broadly stable at around 1,400 in recent years, while some northern prefectures have recorded sharp increases. Last year, Nagano recorded 11 bear-related incidents, including one death, compared with 59 encounters and four deaths in Akita further north and five fatalities in Iwate.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

It works — but we do not know how

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

The element X is one of the most effective mood stabilisers known, but after having been in use for decades, medical researchers still lack consensus about how exactly it works. Leading theories say it affects inositol signalling and inhibits the GSK-3 enzyme, but they haven't been able to explain all of X's effects. Name X.

QUESTION 2

The general form of _____ induce unconsciousness, amnesia, and immobility during surgery and have been used safely for over 150 years, yet scientists still lack a cohesive theory of how they work at the molecular level. Different forms of the drugs also seem to act through somewhat different molecular routes, yet succeed in inducing unconsciousness. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION 3

The BCS theory does a good job

of explaining conventional superconductivity. However, high-temperature superconductors that scientists found in compounds called Y in the 1980s still lack a complete and cogent theoretical explanation for how they superconduct. Name Y.

QUESTION #4

_____, a.k.a. Glucophage, is used worldwide as a first-line drug in the treatment of type II diabetes, yet scientists are still figuring out how it lowers blood glucose levels. Some leading ideas include the drug's effects on the gut microbiome and the mitochondrial complex I. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION #5

At sub-anesthetic doses, name the drug derived from phencyclidine — and which was used as surgical anesthesia during the Vietnam War — that can lift severe depression within hours, in dramatic contrast to the drugs called SSRIs. As with other therapies on this list, its full mechanism of action is still unclear.



Visual: Name the phenomenon depicted here as an aeroplane flies through coloured smoke. A complete analytical theory describing it is one of the Millennium Prize problems. NASA

Answers to August 27 quiz:

1. Businessman who drilled world's first commercial oil well – Ans: **Edwin Drake**
 2. Substance yielded along with crude oil, used to be flared off – Ans: **Natural gas**
 3. Components of hydraulic fracturing fluid – Ans: **Water and sand**
 4. Valve systems that prevented uncontrolled gushing of oil – Ans: **Blowout preventers**
 5. Machines called 'noddling donkeys' to mechanically lift oil – Ans: **Pump jacks**
- Visual: **Paul Thomas Anderson directed There Will Be Blood**

First contact:

Tamal Biswas | K.N. Viswanathan | Raj Sisodiya | Sachin Pant | Anan Rahim

For feedback and suggestions

for 'Science', please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount mobilised by banks in deposits from Indian diaspora

127.23 in \$ billion. India attracted a whopping USD 127.23 billion in Foreign Currency Non-Resident (FCNR-B) deposits under the Reserve Bank's special USD-INR forex swap facility till August 31, the closing date. The RBI's special USD-INR forex swap facility was launched on June 8, 2026. PTI

Length of Manipur's border with Myanmar that has been fenced

55 in kilometres. Manipur Home Minister Govindas Konhoujam on Wednesday said that nearly 55 km out of 398 km of the State's international border with Myanmar has been fenced. Mr. Konhoujam was responding to a calling attention motion raised by Congress MLA K. Ranjit Singh on the "reported proposal for a land swap deal between India and Myanmar". PTI

Number of dengue cases recorded in Delhi till August 29

311 As many as 311 cases of dengue, 119 of malaria and 22 of chikungunya have been recorded in Delhi till August 29 this year, while no death has been reported due to any of the diseases. Delhi recorded its highest monthly tally of dengue cases this year in August, with 90 infections reported during the month, a Municipal Corporation of Delhi report says. PTI

Number of special trains operated during Onam season this year

180 As many as 180 special train services were operated in the Thiruvananthapuram Division during the Onam festive season this year, carrying an additional 2,45,823 passengers, railway officials said here on Wednesday. The division recorded an overall punctuality of 94.67% in August this year, compared to 91% during the same month last year. PTI

Applications received for police recruitment in Himachal Pradesh

98 in thousands. The State Public Service Commission has received over 98,000 applications for police constable recruitment till September 1, 2026, Himachal Pradesh CM Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu told the Assembly on Wednesday. He said the September 5 deadline for application would not be extended. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

Follow us [facebook.com/thehindu](#) [X.com/the_hindu](#) [instagram.com/the_hindu](#)

Constitutional faultlines in FCRA Bill

The FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026 provides for a 'Designated Authority' to oversee the management and disposal of foreign contributions and assets when an organisation's FCRA certificate is cancelled or ceases to exist; raising questions about the extent of State intervention and the need for sufficient safeguards against overreach

LETTER & SPIRIT

Thajaswini C.B.
Siddharth Dev Prasad

It is hard to deny that the state has a legitimate concern in regulating foreign contributions in India, as foreign donations raise issues concerning national security, transparency in democracy, and public accountability. For decades, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act has been the instrument through which this interest has been pursued. However, the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 raises a different question altogether. It goes beyond regulating foreign contributions, to the extent to which the state may intervene in assets and institutional activities associated with them.

The fundamental issue, therefore, is not a debate between civil society and national security. It is about where the State, in pursuit of its legitimate regulatory goal, may cross the boundary from regulating foreign contributions to exercising undue executive control over the institutions that receive them.

The Bill's most important aspect is a statutory framework for the vesting, supervision, management and disposal of foreign contributions and assets through a 'Designated Authority'. Where an organisation's FCRA certificate is cancelled, surrendered or ceases to exist, including due to non-renewal, the Central government may appoint an authority to which the foreign contribution and assets created from it may vest provisionally. The measure is framed as an accountability mechanism to prevent the diversion or abuse of such properties.

Expansion of statutory consequences However, the constitutional difficulty lies elsewhere.

The FCRA has always empowered the state to scrutinise foreign funding. If there are any violations in this regard, registrations can be withdrawn,



Opposition MPs protest in New Delhi on April 1, demanding the withdrawal of the FCRA Amendment Bill.

cancellation can follow continuing non-compliance, and penalties can attach to the diversion or misappropriation of foreign contributions. The Bill, however, represents a significant expansion of the statutory consequences that can follow the loss of FCRA registration. Importantly, the existing FCRA law already contains a provision for vesting assets created from foreign funds upon cancellation. What is new is the detailed statutory framework for their provisional vesting, possession, management, restoration and ultimately, permanent vesting and disposal.

In case of cancellation, surrender, or cessation of registration, the government may, through the Designated Authority, take possession of and manage assets created from foreign contributions and, where considered necessary or expedient in the public interest, undertake the management of the concerned organisation's activities. This is not merely a change in administrative policy; it raises a constitutional question about the extent to which a statute regulating foreign contributions may permit executive authorities to assume possession and, in specified circumstances, management of institutional assets and activities.

Even if the dichotomy between ownership and custody may have some legal relevance, its practical consequences are not. An entity whose success is dependent on the continuity of management will place greater emphasis on control than ownership. Ownership may remain formally undisturbed, but a change in management control fundamentally alters the relationship between the institution and the state. A hospital, school or laboratory is not made effective by ownership alone; it depends on its independence to administer, for charitable ends, what it owns.

Evaluation of proportionality

This is where the doctrine of constitutional proportionality may be relevant. The Supreme Court has repeatedly held that even where the state pursues a legitimate objective, the means it adopts must bear a reasonable connection to that objective and must maintain an appropriate balance between the public purpose and the burden imposed on rights. The amendment raises difficult questions when measured against the said rationale. If the consequence of losing FCRA registration is the provisional vesting of assets in, and potentially the

management of institutional activities by a government-appointed authority, the safeguards attending that transfer must be commensurately robust.

Therefore, the Bill warrants scrutiny of the extent of the discretion delegated to the executive, the safeguards governing its exercise and the standards applicable to decisions concerning possession, management, and permanent vesting. The Bill provides for the restoration of assets when registration is obtained, renewed, or restored within the prescribed period, as well as mechanisms for revision and judicial appeal. The constitutional question is whether these safeguards are sufficiently clear, timely and effective.

This concern becomes more significant against the broader regulatory landscape. Over the past decade, thousands of FCRA registrations have ceased to operate for reasons ranging from non-renewal to alleged statutory violations. While many regulatory actions may be justified, the Bill may increase the consequences arising from the cessation of registration. What might previously have been limited to the loss of eligibility to receive foreign funds could, under the proposed framework, extend to provisional management and, if registration is not restored within the prescribed period, permanent vesting and disposal of assets.

None of this suggests that the government lacks the authority to strengthen financial oversight or ensure that funds from abroad are used for lawful and proper ends. But in a constitutional order, any regime that reaches into the management of civil society's institutional infrastructure must operate within clear legislative standards.

Ultimately, the constitutional question posed by the FCRA Amendment Bill is not whether foreign contributions should be regulated, but how far the state may go in regulating institutions and their assets. (Thajaswini C.B. is an advocate practising before the Supreme Court, Madras and Delhi High Courts. Siddharth Dev Prasad is a 4th year law student at Gujarat National Law University.)

THE GIST

The FCRA has always empowered the state to scrutinise foreign funding. The amendment Bill, however, represents a significant expansion of the statutory consequences that can follow the loss of FCRA registration.

Therefore, the Bill warrants scrutiny of the extent of the discretion delegated to the executive, the safeguards governing its exercise and the standards applicable to decisions concerning possession, management, and permanent vesting.

Can jurists be appointed as Supreme Court judges?

Why has the provision allowing distinguished jurists to be appointed as SC judges remained unused?

Aaratrika Bhaumik

The story so far:

Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan on Sunday questioned why a constitutional provision allowing a "distinguished jurist" to be appointed as a judge of the Supreme Court has remained unused for more than 76 years. Addressing the 13th convocation of National Law University, Delhi's LL.M. programme, Justice Bhuyan pointed out that Article 124(3) of the Constitution permits the appointment of a person who, in the President's opinion, is a "distinguished jurist" as a Supreme Court judge. However, no legal academic has so far been elevated to the top court under this provision.

What does the Constitution stipulate?

Article 124(3) of the Constitution lays down three routes through which a

person may qualify for appointment as a Supreme Court judge – a person must have served as a High Court judge for at least five years, practised as an advocate of a High Court for at least 10 years, or be, in the opinion of the President, a "distinguished jurist".

The provision, however, does not define who qualifies as a "distinguished jurist" or prescribe any minimum period of professional experience for such a person. Its inclusion as a separate category nevertheless indicates that the framers contemplated a route to the Supreme Court beyond the conventional pathways of judicial service and legal practice, potentially opening the door to eminent legal scholars and academics.

What do Constituent Assembly debates reflect?

The "distinguished jurist" category was added to the list of persons eligible for

appointment to the Supreme Court in the draft Constitution. The Constituent Assembly debates reflect that this was intended to bring diversity in professional backgrounds among those appointed to the Bench of the Supreme Court.

Moving the amendment on May 24, 1949, Constituent Assembly member H.V. Kamath said it sought "to open a wider field of choice" for Supreme Court appointments. He noted that persons with "outstanding legal and juristic learning" were "not necessarily confined to judges or advocates", pointing to the selection of judges of the International Court of Justice on similar terms.

The Constituent Assembly debates also referred to the appointment of Felix Frankfurter to the U.S. Supreme Court. In 1939, President Franklin D. Roosevelt appointed Frankfurter, who had been a professor at Harvard Law School for 25 years, as an Associate Justice of the U.S.

Supreme Court. Justice Frankfurter went on to become a noted advocate of the doctrine of judicial restraint – the principle that courts should respect the domain of the elected legislature and the executive, and exercise restraint in interfering with their decisions.

Assembly member M. Ananthasayanam Ayyangar cited Justice Frankfurter's appointment as a "novel experiment" that had worked well, noting that legal expertise was not confined to practising lawyers or judges.

Can a 'distinguished jurist' be appointed as a High Court judge?

The Constituent Assembly had also considered allowing "distinguished jurists" to be appointed as High Court judges. On June 7, 1949, Professor Shibban Lal Saksena moved an amendment proposing their inclusion among those eligible for appointment to a High Court. The proposal, however, was not accepted.

Nearly three decades later, the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, enacted during the Emergency, amended Article 217, which lays down the qualifications for appointment as a High Court judge. The amendment allowed a person who was, in the opinion of the President, a "distinguished jurist" to be appointed to a High Court. The provision came into force in January 1977 but was omitted by the Constitution (Forty-fourth

Amendment) Act, 1978.

What limits the use of this provision?

Despite being part of the Constitution since its inception, the provision has never been invoked. Supreme Court judges have overwhelmingly been appointed from among High Court judges, with only 11 advocates directly elevated from the Bar.

The appointment process itself may also help explain why the provision has remained unused, since a jurist would first have to be recommended by the Supreme Court Collegium. Legal scholar Upendra Baxi, whose possible appointment to the court never materialised, described the provision as a "dead issue" in a 2015 interview with LiveLaw.

Another concern is that legal academics may lack courtroom and procedural experience. However, full-time law teachers themselves face restrictions on practising as advocates. Under Rule 49 of the Bar Council of India Rules, an advocate who takes up full-time salaried employment must cease to practise while such employment continues. In 2019, the Consortium of National Law Universities sought a relaxation of this restriction to allow full-time faculty to practise in courts and bridge the divide between "law in books" and "law in action".

